NATURAL HEALTH MINISTRIES

Guidebook for NHMEC Students

Module 2



HOLISTIC CHRISTIAN HERBALIST

GUIDEBOOK

Instructor

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HOLISTIC CHRISTIAN HERBALIST
GUIDEBOOK

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HOLISTIC CHRISTIAN HERBALIST

GUIDEBOOK

Book Overview

This book serves as a guide for students of the NHMEC to become a Holistic Christian Herbalist from a Christian viewpoint. It does not intend to prescribe, diagnose, or offer medical treatment. Instead, its goal is to educate readers on utilizing natural resources like herbs, fields, and trees for promoting good health. While herbs do not cure ailments, they do support our bodies and assist in the natural healing process. Ultimately, God is seen as the ultimate healer in this context. The book is designed for educational purposes and is presented from a Christian standpoint.

The author, with over 30 years of experience across various modalities and training, incorporates all her knowledge into her teachings. Her extensive involvement in resources, ministries, companies, books, and classes is reflected in her instructional content.

Holistic Christian Herbalists



Biblically Based

HOLISTIC CHRISTIAN HERBALIST
GUIDEBOOK

This course covers herbalism from a Christian perspective. The author, Penny Lane Whittemore CNC. BCNWP, CHGp, RHCH is a certified nutritional consultant and a member of various organizations, including the American Association of Nutritional Consultants, Herbalists without Borders, and the Natural Health Ministries Education Center.

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COURSE OUTLINE

DIRECTIONS

MODULES

- MODULE 1 - WELCOME & OREINTATION
- MODULE 2 - CHRISTIAN HERBALIST
- MODULE 3 - THE HERBALIST'S PATH
- MODULE 4 - HOLISTIC NUTRITION
- MODULE 5 - BIBLICAL NUTRITION & WELLNESS
- MODULE 6 - NATURAL HEALTH
- MODULE 7 - BIBLICAL FAITH & HEALTH CONNECTION

Each module is rich in content and will include its own guidebook. However, please ensure that you complete the course through CANVAS CLASSROOM, as not all information can be contained within this guidebook.
Just know that any future updates, corrections, or additions may not be included in the Guidebook.

DIRECTIONS

Please adhere to the Guidebook, as it contains the assignments, questions, and activities. Remember to:

1. Upon purchase of the Program of Study (Course) you should have received the link to enroll in the Holistic Christian Herbalist Course. If you do not notice the link please check your email.
2. PLEASE READ & REVIEW THE STUDENT HANDBOOK found in the Welcome & Orientation Module.
3. Complete the course as it is assigned by each module. The order of modules are important. Some modules contain an entire class while as some contain a link to a course. There are classes and courses within the Program of Study.
4. complete your internship & training
5. receive your accredited diploma of completion via mail

Utilize note-taking, highlighting, sticky notes, etc., to support your learning process. You can export all content to a PDF annotation app, including Canva.

UPON COMPLETION OF THIS COURSE YOU WILL RECEIVE CERTIFICATE OF COMPLETIONs & ELIGBLE FOR A DIPLOMA OF COMPLETION.



When you see this icon it means that you need to refer to the CANVAS COURSE for the Assignment.

STUDENT INFO

STUDENT NUMBER (LOCATED ON YOUR STUDENT ID CARD) _____

NAME _____

CANVAS STUDENT LOGIN _____

PASSWORD _____

ENROLLED DATE _____
START DATE _____

NOTES;

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HOLISTIC CHRISTIAN HERBALIST

Penny Lane Whittemore CNC BCNWP CHGp RHCH

Module 2
Christian Herbalist

Module 2- Christian Herbalist





Please consult the CANVAS COURSE to fulfill these assignments. Following the CANVAS COURSE CLASSROOM closely is crucial for completing the course in its entirety.

MODULE - Holistic Christian Herbalist

- Video 1
- Video- What is a Christian Herbalism?
- Video- Holistic Herbalism
- Assignment 1.0
- Assignment 1.1
- Video Slides
- Video- What Biblical Evidence that Herbs actually work
- Video Herbalist as a Christian Video
- Video- God's Herbals

Biblical Herbalism

- Video 1
- Video 2
- Video 3
- Video 4
- Video 5
- Video 6
- Video 7
- Read

Herbal Studies

THE STORY BEGINS HERE

Let's review the story together:

"A certain man went down from Jerusalem to Jericho, and fell among thieves, who stripped him of his clothing, wounded him, and departed, leaving him half dead. Now by chance a certain priest came down that road. And when he saw him, he passed by on the other side. Likewise a Levite, when he arrived at the place, came and looked, and passed by on the other side. But a certain Samaritan, as he journeyed, came where he was. And when he saw him, he had compassion. So he went to him and bandaged his wounds, pouring on oil and wine; and he set him on his own animal, brought him to an inn, and took care of him. On the next day, when he departed, he took out two denarii, gave them to the innkeeper, and said to him, 'Take care of him; and whatever more you spend, when I come again, I will repay you.' So which of these three do you think was neighbor to him who fell among the thieves?" And he said, "He who showed mercy on him." Then Jesus said to him, "Go and do likewise." (Luke 10:30-37)

LET US "GO AND DO LIKEWISE"

The Good Samaritan story is a powerful reminder of the compassion, kindness, and selflessness that should characterize our lives as Christians and Christian herbalists. In Luke chapter 10, Jesus teaches us what a "good neighbor" should be like, and as we will learn today, the Good Samaritan serves as a model for our attitude toward hurting people and the use of herbals as a ministry of Jesus living through us.

As we delve deeper into this story, it's essential to understand the historical context. Firstly, the person in question was a Samaritan. The Samaritans were considered "half-breeds" and low-lives by the Jews. The Jewish priests and other religious leaders who heard this story from Jesus must have been irritated that a "Samaritan" was made the hero of the story, especially over them.

However, Jesus's choice of a Samaritan as the hero of the story underlines the importance of compassion and kindness in Christian living. It shows that as Christians, our love for others should transcend race, religion, or social status. Our mission should be to serve others, regardless of their background or beliefs.

The Good Samaritan story also highlights the need for proper training and knowledge to use herbs safely and effectively. When the Good Samaritan bandaged the injured man's wounds, he poured oil and wine, showing that he was a skilled, knowledgeable, and loving herbalist. As Christian herbalists, we must also be knowledgeable, skilled, and well-trained to use herbs properly and safely for each situation.

Moreover, the story emphasizes the importance of using our own resources, time, and money to start and grow our healing ministries, trusting in God to provide for our needs. The Good Samaritan took the injured man to an inn and took care of him, using his own resources. Likewise, Christian herbalists must live by faith and be willing to use their own resources, time, and money to start and grow their healing ministries.

The Good Samaritan story teaches us valuable lessons about compassion, kindness, and selflessness. As Christian herbalists, we must strive to emulate the Good Samaritan's example, demonstrating love and compassion to those in need. We must be motivated by the love of Christ and seek to serve others, regardless of their background or beliefs. It is essential to have proper training and knowledge to use medicinal herbs safely and effectively. Finally, we must be willing to use our own resources, time, and money to start and grow our healing ministries, trusting in God to provide for our needs. Let us go and do likewise, as Jesus commanded us.

A Good Samaritan refers to a person who helps others in need, especially someone who is a stranger or considered an enemy. It can also refer to a charitable organization or a character in a religious parable. The Samaritans were considered "half-breeds" by the Jews. The Jews who heard this story from Jesus must have been irritated that a Samaritan was made the hero of the story, especially over the Jewish priests and other religious leaders.

Now, let us break down the attributes of this early herbalist, so we can apply what God considers the "best practice" for our Christian healing ministry:

THE STORY BEGINS HERE..

#1: As Christian herbalists, we will have to deal with all kinds of people as we journey and grow. Some will believe, and some will reject God's message of salvation through Jesus Christ. Regardless of the situation, a hurting person needs compassion. Compassion is defined by the Random House Dictionary as: "a feeling of deep sympathy and sorrow for another who is stricken by misfortune, accompanied by a strong desire to alleviate the suffering." Christian herbalists must build their ministry on compassion, mercy, and the love of Jesus.

#2: The Good Samaritan "went to him" and bandaged his wounds. We are to "go" to the hurting people of this world and "bandage" their wounds. First, the spiritual wounds, then the emotional wounds, and finally the physical wounds. A Christian herbalist will "go" with the attitude of supporting people and making new disciples for Jesus.

#3: After the Good Samaritan bandaged the injured man's wounds, he poured oil and wine. This Good Samaritan was truly a skilled, knowledgeable, and loving herbalist! Olive oil and the tincture of the grape, a wonderful antiseptic, antibiotic, anti-inflammatory, and analgesic combination of herbs. Like this Good Samaritan, Christian herbalists must be knowledgeable, skilled, and well-trained to know which herbs to properly and safely use for each situation.

#4: After the Good Samaritan set the injured man on his own animal, he brought him to an inn and took care of him. And then the Good Samaritan took some of his own money and gave it to an innkeeper, and said to him, "Take care of him; and whatever more you spend, when I come again, I will repay you." Christian herbalists must live by faith and be willing to use their own resources, time, and money to start and grow their healing ministries.

GOD FIRST

Remember, good Christian herbalist, when you put God first and love your neighbor as yourself, God will bless you, take care of you, and provide for all your needs and the needs of your Christian healing ministry. That's a PROMISE from God. Now let us go and live it as Good Samaritans and Christian herbalists!

"Seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness, and all these things shall be added to you." (Matthew 6:33)

In conclusion, the Good Samaritan story is a powerful reminder for us as Christian herbalists. We must strive to be like the Good Samaritan, who had compassion and demonstrated selfless love to the injured man. Christian herbalists should be motivated by the love of Christ and seek to serve others, regardless of their background or beliefs. It is essential to have proper training and knowledge to use herbs safely and effectively. Finally, we must be willing to use our own resources, time, and money to start and grow our healing ministries, trusting in God to provide for our needs. Let us go and do likewise, as Jesus commanded us.



HOLISTIC CHRISTIAN HERBALIST

The Holistic Christian Herbalist online course provides participants with a comprehensive introduction to the basics of herbs and their uses, with a specific focus on the tripartite nature of man (body, soul, & spirit), as viewed from a Christian Bible-based perspective.

This course is ideal for those who are interested in acquiring knowledge about natural preparations for holistic health & wellness, as well as insights into herbs and their uses, and biblical pathways to wholeness. Through completion of this course, participants can gain knowledge on biblical herbs and their properties, phytonutrients, & constituents, as well as the different ways in which herbs can be used, including in teas, tinctures, and salves.

This unique course is designed to provide an introduction to the world of herbs and holistic pathways of wholeness, making it suitable for beginners who are just starting out with herbal preparations. Additionally, those with some existing knowledge of herbs in the bible can benefit from learning more in a Christian context.

Throughout the course, participants will gain insight into various biblical herbs and their properties, including identification and potential benefits. Additionally, they will discover different ways to use herbal preparations for optimal health and wellness, such as in tinctures, teas, salves, oils, and more. Furthermore, participants will learn how to successfully wild forage and harvest herbs, as well as how to properly identify them in their natural environment.

Upon completion of the course, participants will be equipped with the knowledge and skills to create various herbal preparations, which can benefit their optimal health and wellness. They will have learned how to formulate recipes using the information provided in the quick easy sheets, which will enable them to continue creating their own herbal remedies at home. Additionally, participants will have learned how to create and utilize herbal infused oils for future use, which can be used in a variety of ways such as in cooking, skincare, and even in aromatherapy.

Holistic Christian Herbalist with health & wellness offers a unique learning experience that combines the support of holistic biblical pathways & herbs with a Christian perspective. Participants will come away from the course with a deeper understanding of herbs and their potential benefits, as well as a newfound appreciation for the tripartite man.

In conclusion, if you are interested in learning more about herbs and their uses, and how to create natural preparations for holistic health & wellness, then the Christian Holistic Herbalist course is the perfect choice for you.

"For the service of man." (Ps 104:14)



WHAT IS A CHRISTIAN HERBALIST?

Holistic Christian Herbalists are individuals who follow the beliefs of the Bible and are dedicated to a natural health and healing ministry. Unlike other herbalists, Christian herbalists combine the healing power of Jesus' atonement to God provided herbs with faith in God's Word to help heal themselves and others. They rely on evidence-based practices to ensure that they provide the best care possible.

The three healthcare priorities of every Christian herbalist are spiritual health, emotional (soul) health, and bodily health (1 Thessalonians 5:23). These three areas are interconnected and should be treated as such. When one area is out of balance, the others are affected as well. Christian herbalists understand this and aim to provide holistic care that addresses the root cause of any health issue.

In order to achieve spiritual health, Christian herbalists may recommend prayer, meditation, and other spiritual practices. They believe that a strong spiritual foundation is essential for overall health and well-being. Emotional health, or the health of the soul, is also important for a person's overall well-being. Christian herbalists may recommend consulting, coaching, or other forms of emotional support to help their clients achieve emotional balance. Finally, bodily health is essential for a person's overall well-being. Christian herbalists may recommend a variety of herbal remedies to help support & aid physical wellness and improve bodily health.

Overall, Christian herbalists provide a unique approach to optimal health that combines faith with evidence-based practices. They understand the interconnectedness of the mind, body, and spirit, and aim to provide holistic care that addresses all aspects of a person's well-being, meaning the triparted man.







AS A CHRISTIAN







As a Christian, it is acceptable to utilize herbs for health and wellness, but it is important to exercise discernment when studying herbalism in today's world. Personally, I have questioned all things and allowed the Holy Spirit to guide me. Discernment involves comprehending the principles of God, knowing His word from the Bible, and being directed by the Holy Spirit to make sound decisions. It is crucial to test the spirit and see what the Bible says about it.

Everything I am about to share is based on my own experiences studying herbalism while growing spiritually as a Christian, and learning to not only be a soldier but a warrior and ambassador of Christ. I want to share how I was unintentionally headed down a path of worshiping creation instead of the Creator, including practices like Wicca, White Witch, Sorcery, and Witchcraft. These practices were on the borderline of worshiping Bael and other occult practices.

For Christians considering studying herbalism, it is important to exercise discernment. While some may have concerns about the potential dangers, it is also important to recognize that God created plants for our use in wellness and food. Recently, a group of Christian women expressed interest in learning about herbs from classes that I had previously offered, and it was then that I realized what I had been shielded from 11 years ago. Here is my story.

I started learning about herbalism as a teenager while growing up on a small farm with my dad, who was a Master Gardener, and my resourceful mom. They taught me how to cultivate plants, trees, and animals, as well as how to use them in recipes.

In the late 80s, my dad was diagnosed with non-Hodgkin's lymphoma cancer and shingles. At the time, there were not many herbal products available to help him, so I began researching at local libraries, universities, herb communities, groups, extension offices, and more. I hoped to find someone to mentor me with herbal recipes. Eventually, I found a lady who took me to her vast and overgrown farm for wild harvest, which was exactly what I needed to get started.

AS A CHRISTIAN...

After graduating high school, I pursued my interest in herbalism by taking a local community class on making herbal remedies. I also completed various online programs and hands-on local programs, and read extensively on the topic. In addition, I took university and institute classes, as well as online accredited classes to deepen my knowledge of herbalism. After receiving my diploma in natural health and certification in holistic nutrition, I opened a Natural Health Ministry that offered consulting with a focus on Natural Health and Holistic Nutrition, including Iridology. I organized classes at the local library and formed a group. Additionally, I published books on Backyard Herbs of KY and had them in the local bookstore. However, in 2010, I received a letter from the government requesting me to remove all of my books from the shelf and close the Natural Health Ministry. The letter threatened that if I did not comply, my lab would be closed, my books would be thrown away, and my website would be deleted. Unfortunately, this happened to my professor at that time, whose lab was closed, items destroyed, and she was arrested never to be heard from again. I received a terrifying email supposedly from her assistant. Feeling rejected, my self-esteem plummeted, and I thought I was in the wrong. I asked God, "You gave me this gift, this vision, now what do I do with it?" For 11 years, I laid dormant and desolate in my herbalism practice. But then, suddenly, God moved, and the doors were flung open. A group of Christian women approached me and asked me to teach them what I knew. I felt overwhelmed, delighted, scared, disorganized, and confused. Although the Bible tells us that confusion and fear are not from God, I couldn't ignore the discernment I felt. I sensed a hesitation in myself about the content of the classes, even though the doors were open. I decided to review and refresh my knowledge on the subject matter, as it had been 11 years since I last taught. I realized that things had changed in the herbal world since then and I needed to update my teaching material. As I looked over the content I was promoting and affiliated with, I saw some things that weren't pleasing to God.

I then realized the reason why the door had been closed all those years back. I also understood that the content I had was not pleasing to God, especially if Christian women were going to take the classes. Discernment taught me that the doors had been shut to protect me as a Christian and a child of God so that I would not go down the wrong path into occult practices.







AS A CHRISTIAN...



During this revelation time, I met with the ladies several times and realized that the old material in my classes did not align with the word of God. The companies I was once affiliated with had turned to promoting profane ads and words in their herb guides' documentation, which upset me as a Christian, a pastor's wife, and an educator. These former things that I thought were right by God's standards were no longer lining up with the word of God.

My eyes were opened, and my heart was heavy. I had to change the way I teach, the books, the documents, and redo everything I was affiliated with. I began my journey of rewriting the classes, spiritual fasting and praying, and spiritual deliverance and repentance. With much visualization, binding my mind to the mind of Christ, I decided to open up a classroom via Google and a church building to hold monthly in-person meetings to be an ambassador of Christian Herbalism. I teach others a Christian perspective of Herbalism using God's principles of a healthful living.



Currently, herbalism is not a recognized health care modality in our country, despite having a history of thousands of years as a significant health system worldwide. Because of this lack of recognition in the United States, there is no state or national licensing board for herbal practitioners, and no recognized credentials or titles, such as "master" herbalist or "certified" herbalist. Although certain independent entities, third-party organizations, or institutes not related to any governing legal boards do qualify individuals with certain titles based on their education and experience, these titles hold no value in the eyes of governmental and most state governing bodies.



AS A CHRISTIAN...

I hold certifications through a third party, the American Association of Nutritional Consultants (AANC) as a certified nutritional consultant & the American Association of Natural Wellness Practitioners as a board certified natural wellness practitioner. I also have diplomas from various institutes such as the International Institute of Holistic Healing, Stratford Career Institute, Natural Health School, and Ky Vo-Tech, as well as certificates of completion from various institutes such as Expert Rating and Universal Class. Additionally, I have undergone hands-on training, mentorships, and self-study. Currently, I am a student of Dr. Ellen Tart-Jensen for Iridology. I have studied under various herbalists, naturopathic doctors, alternative medicine doctors, community herbalists, and a Master Gardener. I am also a Certified Homeschooling Professional, Certified Health Aid, formerly a Certified Nurse Assistant and Client Care Specialist (CNA & SRNA) from the state of KY, and a current Certified Nutritional Consultant (CNC), BCWP, Natural Health Consultant (NHC dip.), Holistic Nutritional Consultant (HNC dip.), and so many more.

Aromatherapy is a bit different from other areas of alternative health practice. Aromatherapists are considered practitioners and are "officially" certified through two main governing entities: NAHA (United States) and AIA (International), based on years of training and experience. While I am not an aromatherapist, I do make and use herbal oils.

Now, this is my personal conviction, but let's be honest and serious for a moment. As a Christian, there are certain moral standards that should be maintained on a daily basis. It's not just about following the Ten Commandments. If we profess to be Christians, we need to walk the walk, do it, live by it, and show it. We need to know what spirit we are of and what we are worshiping. It's easy to be influenced by demonic forces, world trends, movements, or theologies, but do they align with the Word of God? While the Bible says that good is present where evil is, we will be held accountable for everything we say, do, and live by. If we teach, we will also be held accountable.

As I looked around my herbal community, I noticed things that were ungodly and Christian women who were unaware that they were participating in these events. When we participate in or attend something that lacks the principles of God, we should avoid it. While there is good and bad in everything, we should pray for discernment and protection from deception. Take heed lest ye fall.

There are spiritual deities, spirits, and remnants of evil spirits that can be associated with ungodly things. These can affect a Christian's lifestyle, influencing their flesh, way of thinking, and even their beliefs. While Christians cannot be possessed by demonic forces, they can still be influenced by them in terms of their faith. If you don't believe me, read the Bible for yourself. Study God's word using true word-for-word translations, not the new age message-to-message bibles.

As a woman of faith, I offer a loving gesture to Christians who are herbalists, aromatherapists, or interested in learning about using herbs and essential oils with a Christian perspective in a Godly atmosphere. Christians have the right to their beliefs in this increasingly anti-Christian world. I am denominational and believe in the word-for-word Bible. I do not judge anyone, but I want to share the discernment I have gained through my studies and practice of herbalism. I strive to align myself with the word and maintain a balanced lifestyle that promotes wellness and optimal health.



WHAT IS HOLISTIC CHRISTIAN HERBALISM?

- Holistic Herbalism is based upon a belief in the body's innate God-bestowed natural ability to heal itself when given an appropriate internal and external healing environment while using God's medicine that he provided from plants, herbs, trees, foods, oils, etc.
- Herbalists are not involved in the practice of medicine, treat, diagnose, or prescribe, nor do not use drugs or pharmaceuticals, nor do they perform surgery.
- Holistic Herbalists are not doctors but laypersons, ministers, coaches, consultants, mentors, & practitioners.
- Holistic Herbalists may use other modalities based on the facts and not based on traditions, doctrines & philosophies of men but rely on Gods word, the Holy Ghost as the teacher, & scientific evident of facts.
- Biblical herbalism is a distinct system of non-invasive healthcare and health assessment with dependence being placed upon education, counseling, Biblical modalities, and the use of God-given natural substances (herbs & herbal preparations) to help support and aid the individual's intrinsic self-healing processes that God put into order.
- In reality, holistic herbalism is based on Biblical principles and deals with wellness, relief, & inner healing from conditions that are the result of spiritual, mental, nutritional, environmental, or physical factors. Including spiritual, soul, & physical deliverance.
- All involving the triparted man; the soul (mind, will, & emotions along with the senses), body (physical body, & the flesh), Spirit.
- Christian Herbalists do not incorporate any modality that is of the dark occult. There is good & bad in everything. However, there is a fine line between these two. Discernment from the Holy Ghost is needed to determine in some cases of study to know the difference.
- Holistic Christian Herbalists are trained specialists in a separate and distinct healing art that operates according to Biblical principles. They use non-invasive natural and spiritual modalities such as foods, herbs, and prayer. They are not orthodox medical doctors (M.D.s). Holistic Christian Herbalists have participated in a specialized course of study in conventional holistic, naturopathic, herbal ology subjects such as anatomy, physiology, consulting, dietary evaluations, nutrition, herbology, acupressure, homeopathy, iridology, sclerology, detoxification, modalities & therapies of natural health & wellness.
- In addition, they have training in prayer, laying on of hands, anointing with oil, inner healing, and the removal of demonic influences. Holistic Christian Herbalists cooperate with all branches of medical science, referring individuals to a physician or other practitioner as appropriate.
- In practice, Biblical Naturopaths utilize Godly, natural, and God-revealed science-based evaluative procedures to develop an individualized protocol for individuals seeking improvement and restoration of health and wholeness.
- Holistic Christian Herbalists do not diagnose or label people with the names of medical diseases, nor are they involved in the practice of medical procedures. Neither do they use pharmaceutical drugs, nor do they perform surgery. In essence, they can be drugless practitioners trained in Biblical principles for the purpose of ministering to the whole person: spirit, soul, and body.
- In no way does Holistic Christian Herbalists treat, diagnose, prescribe, or cure any disease or ailments. For they are not DOCTORS and can not perform such tasks as a system doctor.
- Herbalist use herbal preparation protocols to refer to for individualized wellness & wholeness.

WHAT DOES HOLISTIC MEAN?

Holistic Herbalists typically approach their practice holistically, taking into consideration all aspects of the human experience: physical, mental, emotional, and spiritual. They also analyze the phytonutrients and properties of plants, like whether they are cooling, warming, drying, moistening, lax, tense, etc. Moreover, they account for the human body's properties and the specific issue that needs to be addressed.

The spiritual dimension of herbalism can pose challenges for Christians due to the belief in spiritual causes of illnesses. However, I prefer not to use the term "energetics" because I do not delve into vibration, anti-christ meditation, or herb energies of the plant, as they may be perceived as bordering on negative influences. Nevertheless, I acknowledge the body's rhythmic processes as divinely ordained by God. For he is the source of my rhythm. Every living being has a rhythm, a life force flowing through them - for Christians, this is likened to "living water" coursing through their veins. Just like a river's flow leaves an imprint on the land, this rhythm is seen as a God-given order. Including every breathe is the breath of God entering our lungs.

Understanding these rhythms and aligning with them is crucial for maintaining health and well-being. Herbalists often seek to harmonize the body's natural processes with the supportive properties of plants.

To practice herbalism in a way that respects both the physical and spiritual aspects of health, one must cultivate a deep respect for the plants themselves. By doing so, herbalists honor the interconnectedness of all life and the divine design they believe is present in nature.

In practical terms, this holistic approach means that an herbalist might recommend chamomile tea to soothe both the body and the mind, aiding in relaxation and better sleep. They might suggest ginger for its warming properties to invigorate the circulatory system or peppermint for its cooling effect to calm digestive issues. Each recommendation is made with an understanding of the individual's unique constitution and the specific imbalance they are experiencing.

Ultimately, the practice of herbalism is seen as a partnership with nature, an endeavor to restore balance and promote healing through the gentle, yet powerful, gifts of the plant kingdom. For those who integrate their faith with their practice, it becomes an expression of stewardship and gratitude for the natural world, reflecting a deep-seated belief in the harmony between creation and Creator.



WHAT ARE OCCULT PRACTICES?

God explicitly tells us to stay away from any occult practices. This includes divination, astrology, spell-casting, chanting, and more. Many pagan systems, Wiccan practices, Gaia worship, animism, and other belief systems (religions) that aren't aligned with Christian principles and Biblical living include practices that most Christians understand are of the occult.

In addition to occult practices, worship of other gods is also forbidden by our Father. We see this in animistic practices, worship of creation/nature, and references to the divine goddess and others. Basically, if it doesn't align with the word of God, leave it alone. These influences can be so subtle that a Christian can be unaware of the original base behind a pyramid marketing scheme, a cultural religious ceremony that involves herbs, the reading of tea leaves, the throwing of sticks, etc. that leads to sorcery.

Don't believe me? That's okay, because as a Christian, I will pray for you to have your eyes enlightened and the discernment that you need to manifest and show you. As a Christian, God is the ultimate healer, and He has given us all we need on this earth for our health and to have a healthy life. He made the plants perfectly, with the incredible interactions between the phytochemistry of a plant to help our bodies with the support it needs to heal itself and to be well.

An example of this is a commonly known pain-relieving herb called willow bark (Salix alba). Willow is what we use in our home as a natural aspirin substitute. Because we're using the whole plant, we don't suffer the side effects that man-made aspirin has. Most people in these modern times have no trouble turning to man-made science that has stripped only the active ingredients from the plants God has provided to us. However, it's time we take a good look at what's going on here, how we are being influenced and by what manner to make our own decisions about what we put into our bodies.

As Christians, our bodies are the temple of the Holy Ghost. If we defile our bodies, how can the spirit still live in us if impurities and malnourishment choke it out? If we are not well in body, possibly due to a diseased and weak body, how can we serve the Lord in fullness as Jesus commanded with the great commission?

God created plants for us, as stated in the Bible. As Christians, we have the right to re-learn how to use plants for our health. We should learn to use plants for wellness, first aid, and optimal health.

We need to study the principles that God gave us for healthy living in his word, based on the design of the human body and what it needs to function properly. Our foods no longer contain the original phytonutrients that God intended, so it's important to support our bodies with the nutrients they need.

Our farmers are not taking the necessary steps to naturally care for the soil. Instead, they are using synthetic means to support and care for the soil, which allows it to produce nutrient-packed plants. However, this approach results in foods that lack nutrients, which affects the human body in a chain reaction. As a result, people supplement their bodies once again with manufactured herbal dietary supplements or even fabricated injections or synthetic extracts.

As a farmer's daughter, I know that it isn't hard to rotate crops, create composts, and add animal waste to fertilize the organic way. However, it does take time, and cutting corners to produce a "microwave society" of foods is not the solution. Nowadays, we have hydro farming, which adds synthetic supplementation to ensure that it follows certain FDA guidelines to make sure it is fit for consumption. Although many plants can be successfully grown by hydro, it is still messing with the natural order of God's design. The soil was lacking, and the runoffs from polluted waters around the area were affecting the plants, leading to the need for supplementation.

As Christians, it's essential to be cautious as we study herbals. It's easy for a Christian, especially one who is new or who lacks understanding of Biblical principles, to end up on a path that includes practices that are not aligned with our beliefs. For example, yoga teaching and practice come from the Hindu religion, and chanting mantras during yoga practice, casting spells, using pendants, crystals, or tarot cards, stick throwing, leaf readings to divine the future, and looking to astrology for answers are practices that are not in line with Christian beliefs. Additionally, including Gaia or Earth as a healer or Mother Earth as a type of healer is not consistent with Godly principles.

WHAT ARE OCCULT PRACTICES?

Herbs cannot heal! They are not medicine or gods! The study of herbalism is often connected to the study of plants, but many herbal schools include practices that are not compatible with Christian beliefs. Cultural and diversity teachings may incorporate the spiritual healing of herbs based on religious practices and traditions from other countries. Even so-called Christian Herbal Schools may not be founded on Christian beliefs. As Christians, we believe in the Creator, not the created. As a Christian herbalist, I choose the Creator. It is easy to worship the creation instead of the Creator.

It is vital to my relationship with Christ that I be on guard as a warrior for theories that aren't biblical. I must consciously and intentionally put aside any theories that do not align with my Christian beliefs, referring to God's word as a reference. I can better choose mentors and volunteers who share my beliefs and avoid those who do not. Otherwise, I can bring reproach to my ministry and to the Health Center itself.

As an Ambassador of Christian Herbalists, I protect the Christian perspective of using herbs. From now on, I will often say in my teachings that God created the plants for us. Herbs are not our healers. God has provided herbs for our wellness since the beginning. Remember the song: "be careful little eyes what you see, be careful little ears what you hear." I see myself as one of those soldiers in Gideon's army, holding the sword of truth and using my eyes to look out for the enemy. I am a warrior, not just a soldier waiting for deployment. If someone judges me for "adding my religion" to my teaching, I will remember that Satan, the anti-Christ demonic spirit, and Jezebel have been given authority to be loosened, but through Jesus' blood, I have been given authority over all manner of things in this world and beneath it. I also remind myself that if others can share their beliefs, so can I. I can be an Ambassador of Christian Herbalists.

As you read the following quote from a book, consider how a Christian might come to be influenced by beliefs that are not aligned with God's. The quote, below, is not unusual to see in many herbal books. References to all kinds of unbiblical things abound all over the world, and that includes excellent herbal resources and courses. The author, whom I will not name, is a well-published, well-educated, and well-influenced herbalist and world traveler. He traveled to foreign lands in search of these plant remedies to bring them back to practice, but unfortunately, he also brought back the demonic influence. He partnered up with the Grandmother of Herbalists, and their partnership began along with the studies of herbalism. Anyways here is the expert from the book;

"...but just as our Earth feeds us, heals our arthritis, and strengthens the function of our hearts, so it supports and nurtures our nervous systems. Herbalism is a cooperative healing venture among humanity, plants, and the Earth. This experience of wholeness is spirit in action, and opens the door for change and transformation. Nature provides us with herbs that transform and enlighten as well as plants that heal and nurture the nerve tissue itself...." The quote above may seem innocent, but if you substitute "God" for "Earth" and/or "Nature," you can see the potential danger if we're not aware. There's a thin difference between worshiping the Creator versus worshiping the created, but it is there and can be subtle or overwhelming.

As a Christian, I believe that it's God who feeds us, provides for us, gave his only son Jesus for our healing, and gave authority over death, hell, and the grave. However, can you see where an innocent study of herbalism might lead one down an incorrect path? This expert's seemingly innocent statement of belief implies that it's not actually God doing the work. Such a statement could easily be thoughtlessly read and accepted by a Christian.

Most non-Christians may be unaware of the potential demonic influence that can be intertwined with herbalism. As Christians, it is our responsibility to educate each other. Many Christian women I have spoken to, who were previously interested in taking my classes before I gained discernment and enlightenment, did not believe me when I warned them that studying an ungodly item can interfere, bring reproach, and even hold a type of demonic influence that could transfer to them or to their church. Some of them even led Yoga, Meditation, Reiki, and other forms of ungodly-based therapy classes right inside the church building. Only when they received a letter from a former Warlock-turned-Christian that explained the reasons why and why nots, etc., did they finally see the error of their ways.

DID THE CHURCH TAKE HEED?

Herbs do not heal; they are not drugs. If you are a Christian and interested in herbalism, be aware that every gift God has given us can be tainted in some way by the enemy (1 Peter 5:8-9). Before diving in, study herbalism with discernment and be knowledgeable about what you will encounter.

Be aware that many ideologies and theologies that aren't Biblical abound in herbalism, such as New Age concepts, gender issues, elements of goddess worship, and animism. Knowing this ahead of time will allow you to make better decisions about schools, teachers, product affiliations, groups, clubs, and agencies that you choose.

It matters if you are affiliated with a product that uses profanity in their advertisements. They may have a history of being a pyramid scheme business or may have changed their business model and marketing tactics. If you are affiliated with the profanity of the world, then you are partaking in their sin and will be held accountable unless you have repented. As a Christian, why would you want to promote or sell products from a company that uses unprofessional and profane tactics to gain sales? It's unfortunate to spend thousands of dollars on herbal education and products only to find out that they go against your Christian beliefs.

Approach herbalism with your eyes open, and study with discernment to ensure that you are promoting products and ideas that align with your faith. Remember that every gift from God can be tainted by the enemy, and it is up to you to stay awake and be aware. (1 Peter 5:8-9) God gave us plants to use for both food and medicine. As it is written in Revelation 22:2, "On either side of the river was the tree of life, bearing twelve kinds of fruit, yielding its fruit every month; and the leaves of the tree were for the healing of the nations."

As a practicing herbalist, I have seen firsthand how people who follow their doctor's orders often experience terrible health issues due to the side effects of their medications. While I do not suggest that you stop taking prescribed medicine or not listen to your physician, I do encourage you to examine alternative options beyond the norm and what is most cost-efficient.

During this pandemic, man-made medicine and doctor visits have been limited, and the financial crisis has further complicated matters. What if you need medical attention and no one is available to you? As a Christian, I believe that we should rely first and foremost on God, but He also gave us plants, herbs, and leaves for our medicine. I encourage everyone to learn herbal skills as it's a way to achieve wellness and optimal health using the plants that God gave us. Teaching people to set up home apothecaries for their families is a goal I hope to achieve. Having particular herbs, spices, and plants readily available, whether in the cupboard, garden, or elsewhere, can be useful when needed.

As Christians, we need to practice certain moral guidelines when it comes to being in the world but not participating in it. There are many influences such as anti-Christ and idol worship that can be linked to several techniques, herbal theologies, remedies, and so on. I have researched these links with a former Warlock who is now a Christian, a pastor, and one of my herbal mentors. He stated that researching these links between herbs and spiritual identities was deeper and more hidden than most people knew. Some things that were so hidden had a demonic spirit behind them and were so deceitful that the person didn't even realize it was there. My research continued, but ended when I realized that I didn't want the influence of the research to develop an infatuation with the demonic world itself. Therefore, there was another moment when research became a door to the ungodly.

Remember, if something doesn't align with the word of God, then leave it alone. If you don't know God's word, then get a Bible and read it. If you don't understand it, then pray to God for understanding and discernment. If you're not a child of God, then ask Him for repentance. Romans 8. I am here to mentor you in herbalism from a Christian perspective, as an Ambassador of Christian Herbalists. If you are interested in taking classes from Herbal Blessings Education, hosted by the Natural Health Ministry Education Center, please visit me on Facebook at Natural Health Ministry Education Center. I offer classes in Herbalism, Natural Health, Holistic Nutrition, Iridology, Essential Oils, and Food as Medicine, all guided by God's principles of healthful living.

CHRISTIAN HERBALIST

As a believer, I firmly believe that herbs can contribute to optimal health and wellness. However, discernment is crucial when studying herbalism in today's world. I have carefully questioned all things and allowed the Holy Spirit to guide me in making good choices, based on the principles of God and His word in the Bible.

I have learned from my experiences as a Christian and an herbalist, growing not only as a soldier but as a warrior and ambassador of Christ. My journey has taught me to be cautious about the path I choose, as I was once unknowingly headed towards worshiping the creation instead of the Creator. This included borderline practices of Wicca, White Witch, Sorcery, Witchcraft, and other occult practices.

If you are a Christian considering studying herbalism, discernment is crucial. Some Christians may be apprehensive about the potential dangers of learning herbalism, and there are reasons for this. On the other hand, God has created plants for us to use for our wellness and food.

I realized this when a group of Christian women approached me about teaching them what I knew. I was overwhelmed, delighted, scared, and confused. However, I knew that confusion and fear are not of God, and I trusted the discernment that God had given me. I revisited my old materials and realized that they were not aligned with God's word. I felt a release to start new classes, with a Christian perspective on herbalism using God's principles for a healthful living.

Currently, in the United States, herbalism is not a recognized health care modality. There is no state or national licensing board for herbal practitioners, and there are no recognized credentials or titles, including "master" herbalist or "certified" herbalist. However, certain independent entities, third-party organizations, or institutes not related to any governing legal boards do qualify individuals with certain titles, depending on their education and experience. I hold certification through a third party, the American Association of Nutritional Consultants AANC. I also hold diplomas from various institutes and certificates of completion from various institutes, along with hands-on training, mentorships, and self-teaching.

As a Christian, I believe in maintaining moral standards on a daily basis. We need to know what spirit we are of and what we are worshipping. It is easy to get influenced by demonic forces, world trends, movements, or theologies. However, everything we say, do, and live by will be held accountable. I urge Christians who are studying herbalism to pray for discernment and to take heed lest they fall. We need to be cautious about participating in ungodly events, as they can be influenced by spiritual deities, spirits, or remnants of evil spirits. These can transfer over to a Christian's lifestyle, flesh, way of thinking, and way of believing. We must study God's word to discern what is of Him and what is not.

In summary, I am confident in my faith and my pursuit of herbalism. I believe that the principles of God and His word in the Bible are crucial in making good choices. As a Christian herbalist, I aspire to teach other Christians how to use herbs for optimal health and wellness, while aligning with God's principles of a healthful living.

BECOMING A CHRISTIAN HERBALIST

If you feel called to be a Christian herbalist, then you should know that becoming one requires a strong commitment to the study and practice of Christian herbal preparations. This commitment begins with a call and a vision, but it also requires dedication and perseverance.

To start your journey towards becoming a Christian herbalist, you must first study God's Word. The Bible is a rich source of information on whole (holistic) health and healing, and it is essential that you understand its true meaning before you can effectively practice as a Christian Herbalist

Next, you need to broaden your knowledge by studying human anatomy and physiology, medicinal herbs, herbal preparations, contraindications, side effects, and use. This is a lifelong process that requires patience and a willingness to learn. With time and practice, you will be able to apply this knowledge to your own natural health care ministry.

Finally, you must learn how to organize and practice your natural health care ministry safely and effectively. This involves developing a system for managing patient information, creating suggested wellness plans, and maintaining accurate records. It also involves ensuring that your practice is in compliance with all applicable laws and regulations in your city, county, state, & country.

Becoming a Christian herbalist is a journey that requires a lifetime commitment to studying and practicing. While it may seem daunting, the rewards of helping others achieve whole (holistic) health and healing through the power of Christian herbalism are immeasurable.

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One of God's principles for a healthful living is to read the word of God and observe how Jesus conducted himself. This includes how he interacted with others, nourished his own body, prayed, served others, and finished the plan that lay ahead of him while maintaining God's principles and a healthful living.

Another principle for a healthful living is treating our bodies as temples of the Holy Ghost which is an essential part of a healthy lifestyle. In order to do so, it is important to consume natural and wholesome foods. Fortunately, the Bible provides us with many examples of good food choices that can help us achieve optimal health. Here are 10 healing foods from the Bible that you can add to your diet:

- Throughout the Bible, small fruits like figs, grapes, and pomegranates were used widely in beverages, cakes, or eaten as fresh fruit themselves.
    - Pomegranates: Rich in antioxidants, vitamins, and minerals, pomegranates are a great source of nutrition that can help keep your body healthy and vibrant. Pomegranates have high anti-inflammatory, antioxidant, and even anti-tumor properties.
    - Figs: Rich in fiber, vitamins, and minerals, figs are a delicious and nutritious fruit that can help maintain healthy blood pressure and lower the risk of heart disease. Loaded with minerals and vitamins like Vitamin A, K, and E, fresh figs are also low in calories and high in fiber.
    - Grapes: contain resveratrol, a powerful antioxidant known for guarding against colon and prostate cancer as well as reducing stroke risk.
- Honey: Known for its antibacterial properties, honey is not only a great natural sweetener, but it can also help fight infections and promote healing. Raw honey was a highly valued asset in the Bible. When God gave the Israelite people their promised land, it was described as a land flowing with milk and honey—a fertile agricultural area that could produce amazing foods, including bees with raw honey. Not only was honey nutritious and filling, but it was also a valued gift and a sweet metaphor for God's Word. Psalm 119:103 NIV describes how sweet God's words are to the taste, even sweeter than honey to the mouth.

- Olive oil: High in healthy fats and antioxidants, olive oil is a staple in the Mediterranean diet and can help reduce inflammation and protect against chronic diseases. Olive oil was plentiful in Bible times due to the abundant crop of olive trees that continue to bear fruit even into old age. The Garden of Gethsemane, where Jesus prayed for God's will to be done the night before His crucifixion, is known for its gnarled, twisted olive trees. Green olives produced the best fruit and oil. Olives made delicious side dishes pickled or in a relish. The versatile, pressed olive oil was used in baking bread as well as in a salve for wounds, softening skin, in lamps, or even as a sacred anointing oil for kings.
- Fish: Rich in omega-3 fatty acids, fish is a great source of protein that can help reduce inflammation and improve heart health. Fish is a highly nutritious food that was highly valued in biblical times. In fact, God specified in Leviticus 11:9 TLB that people could eat any fish with fins and scales, whether from rivers or seas. Additionally, fish was a staple in Jesus' day, and at least seven of His disciples were fishermen. On various occasions, He ate fish with His disciples and performed two miracles using a boy's lunch of small fish and bread loaves to feed thousands of people.
- Vegetables: The Bible is full of references to vegetables, and for good reason. Vegetables are loaded with vitamins, minerals, and fiber, and can help protect against a variety of chronic diseases.
    - Garlic: With its powerful anti-inflammatory and antibacterial properties, garlic is a versatile ingredient that can be used in many dishes to improve both taste and health.
- Sprouted Grains and Breads In the Bible, bread appears repeatedly as the substance of life. Jesus even referred to Himself as the "Bread of Life." The bread in Bible times used none of the modern and damaging refining methods of today. The kind of nutritious bread they served often involved the sprouting of natural grains and was a basic part of their diets. Whole grain sourdough and sprouted-grain breads involve the soaking or fermentation of grains overnight until the seeds are partially sprouted. This process actually makes these carbohydrates more easily digestible.
- Goat Milk and Products Raw goat milk and cheese were plentiful in Bible times and were not pasteurized like our modern food. More easily digestible than cow's milk, goat's milk also has less lactose and contains multiple vitamins, enzymes, and proteins. According to Jordan Rubin, 65% of the world's population drinks goat's milk. It can help in the treatment of inflammatory diseases, is a complete protein, and is also useful in soaps.
- Beans and Lentils Beans or lentils (legumes) were served widely in the Old Testament, probably since they are such good sources of protein. Legumes are plentiful in folate, especially important to pregnant women, are good antioxidants, and are low in saturated fats.
    - Lentils: A great source of protein, fiber, and complex carbohydrates, lentils are a nutritious food that can help regulate blood sugar levels and promote digestive health.
- Nuts Pistachio and almond nuts, both found in the Bible, are low-calorie snacks. Pistachio nuts are high as antioxidants and contain more lutein (1000%) than other nuts. Almonds, mentioned several times in the Bible, are one of the highest protein and fiber nuts and contain manganese, magnesium, and calcium, necessary ingredients for the body.
    - Almonds: High in protein, healthy fats, and antioxidants, almonds are a great snack that can help reduce inflammation and support brain function.

BECOMING A CHRISTIAN HERBALIST

- Flax Flax was used with linen in the Bible to make clothes. But it also had great medicinal value because of its high fiber, Omega-3 fatty acids, protein, and lignan count. It contains one of the highest plant sources of lignans, almost 800 times more than any other. These help as antioxidants, in maintaining blood sugar, cholesterol, and even in cancer prevention.
- Spices, Seasonings, and Herbs In the Old and New Testament, scores of spices were used as both food and medicines, as well as in making perfumes or incense, and were given as expensive, royal gifts. Cinnamon, known for its aromatic fragrance, as a spice has one of the highest antioxidant values known. Garlic is often linked to helping heart and immune issues. Other spices of the Bible include coriander, frankincense, mint, dill, balm, aloes, myrrh, and rue. Each contained healing properties such as promoting digestion, aiding the immune system, relieving pain, or fighting infections.
- Incorporating these healing foods into your diet can help you achieve optimal health and wellness. Additionally, it is important to eat "grass-fed" and organic products to protect from harmful antibiotics or pesticides. By honoring God's wisdom and using these foods, we can keep our bodies healthy as temples of the Holy Ghost.

HOW DO I BECOME A CHRISTIAN HERBALIST

If you feel called to be a Christian herbalist, then you should know that becoming one requires a strong commitment to the study and practice of Christian herbal preparations. This commitment begins with a call and a vision, but it also requires dedication and perseverance.

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GOD'S HERBALS

INTRODUCTION

The Bible verse in Hebrews 6:7 describes the beautiful cycle of herbals. The cycle starts with rain, which nourishes the thirsty earth. Then, useful herbs are grown by those who cultivate them. Finally, the whole earth receives blessings. As Christian herbalists, we have the privilege of being a part of this cycle of herbal blessings.

THE IMPORTANCE OF WATER

We all know that we need water to survive, but it is also essential for the growth of herbs. Without water, there would be no herbs, and without herbs, there would be no medicine. Medicinal herbs are essential in the field of Christian herbalism, and modern medicine has humble beginnings from them. Ancient medicines were created from the herbs, and modern medicines were formed from herbal chemical templates. It is a fact that modern researchers and chemists copy and modify the chemical templates of herbs to create more powerful medicines.

It is important to remember that the herbal healing blessings that we learn about and share started with the precious gift of water. As Christians, the spiritual symbolism of water is significant. The Bible verse in John 4:14 states that whoever drinks of the water that Jesus gives them will never thirst, and the water will become in them a fountain of water springing up into eternal life. We get life and our medicinal herbs from the precious water of God, and from the precious water of Jesus, we get eternal life. In your Christian herbal ministry, it is essential to share the water of Christ with a thirsty and dying world.

HERBS: A BLESSING OF BEAUTY AND ART

After the spring rains, many colorful herbs fill the landscape near the foothills of my home. It is a beautiful sight to behold! The colorful display and scents of spring herbs give a living testimony to God's great majesty and glory. As Christian herbalists, let us not forget to stop and smell the roses! Sometimes we get so caught up in the intellectual side of what we do that we forget that herbs are not just for medicine but joy, laughter, and provision for other creatures. Herbs are a blessing in sight, smell, taste, and, yes, for the healing of the nations too. But before herbs are a blessing for healing, they are a blessing of beauty and art and a great confirmation to the reality and presence of God.

As Christian herbalists, it is essential to get out there and explore the fields of flowers and God's majesty! Enjoy the wildflowers and herbs in the simplicity of their natural beauty and habitat. Forget about the science and the medicine for a while and just soak it all in. Stop and relax - see, smell, and enjoy the full blessings of the herbs.

THE CULTIVATOR

To cultivate means to help prepare and grow, improve by labor, care, or study. As Christian herbalists, we cultivate medicinal herbs to teach and heal people for God's glory. You are the cultivator and responsible for bringing and sharing the blessing of God and His herbs to the people.

After you stop to "smell the roses," it is time to labor, care, and study the medicinal herbs so that you can continue your calling to serve mankind with love, patience, and whole health healing. As a Christian herbalist, you are the cultivator of medicinal herbs.

GOD'S HERBALS

THE BLESSING

The fullness of the blessing comes when we are obedient and committed to serving God and His people by sharing our knowledge of biblical whole health care and herbs with others. You have been called for a purpose. You have been wired by God to have a passion for herbs, health & wellness. You have been selected to be the cultivator mentioned in Hebrews 6:7. You have been selected to be the one that brings the fullness of the blessing to the world. As a Christian herbalist, you are special because this hurting and evil world needs to hear, see, and taste the Good News of Jesus and His herbs of blessing.

Therefore, let us continue to learn and grow together so that we can continue to build a network of Christian herbalists committed to sharing the blessing of Hebrews 6:7 with others. Remember, the cycle of herbal blessing starts with rain, so let us also pray for rain to nourish the earth and allow our herbs to grow and prosper.

God gives the increase, we just give it room to grow!

"God gives the increase" is a phrase that comes from the King James Version of the Bible, specifically from 1 Corinthians 3:6-7. The passage speaks about how different people may plant and water, but it is God who ultimately brings growth and increase.

HOLISTIC CHRISTIAN HERBALIST

Penny Lane Whittemore CNC BCNWP CHGp RHCH

Module 2
BIBLICAL HERBALISM

Module 2- Biblical Herbalism





Please consult the CANVAS COURSE to fulfill these assignments. Following the CANVAS COURSE CLASSROOM closely is crucial for completing the course in its entirety.

MODULE - Holistic Christian Herbalist

Biblical Herbalism

- Video 1
- Video 2
- Video 3
- Video 4
- Video 5
- Video 6
- Video 7
- Read

Herbal Studies

HERBALIST DEFIND AS A CHRISTIAN

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THE ROLE OF A CHRISTIAN HERBALIST

- In our modern society, a growing number of individuals are exploring alternative medicine to address their health issues. Herbalism is one such method that has been embraced for centuries by diverse cultures worldwide. This class will delve into the role of a Christian herbalist, defining who they are and what their practice entails.. Christian herbalists are practitioners who integrate their faith with the use of natural remedies to promote health and healing. They believe that God has endowed the earth with a wealth of plants and herbs that can support the body's natural healing processes. These practitioners see their work as a way to honor God's creation and to help others achieve wellness in a holistic manner.
- One of the primary roles of a Christian herbalist is to educate their clients about the benefits and uses of various herbs. They provide guidance on how to incorporate these natural remedies into daily life, whether through teas, tinctures, or topical applications, always ensuring that their recommendations align with both scientific knowledge and biblical teachings.
- Christian herbalists also emphasize the importance of prayer and spiritual well-being in the healing journey. They often incorporate prayer into their consultations, seeking divine guidance to better understand and address the individual needs of their clients. This spiritual component is seen as an essential part of the healing process, providing comfort and peace alongside physical remedies.
- Moreover, Christian herbalists advocate for a balanced lifestyle that encompasses not just physical health but also mental and spiritual wellness. They may offer advice on nutrition, exercise, and stress management, encouraging clients to adopt habits that foster overall well-being.
- In doing so, Christian herbalists aim to empower individuals to take charge of their health while nurturing their relationship with God. They serve as compassionate guides, supporting clients as they navigate their health journeys with faith and hope. Through their work, Christian herbalists strive to bring glory to God by helping others experience the healing and wholeness that He desires for all His creation.

WHAT IS A CHRISTIAN HERBALIST?

- A Christian herbalist is an individual who practices herbalism while firmly rooted in their Christian beliefs. They hold the conviction that God has provided natural remedies through herbs and plants to aid in healing the body and enhancing overall health. Often, Christian herbalists combine prayer and scripture with herbal treatments to support their patients' healing journeys. They view their work as a ministry, serving others by integrating their faith with the wisdom of nature. Christian herbalists strive to honor God through their practice, believing that by utilizing the natural resources He has provided, they can promote wellness that aligns with His design for creation. They often emphasize the importance of faith, spiritual well-being, and a holistic approach to health, incorporating both physical and spiritual aspects in their healing practices. By doing so, they aim to foster a deeper connection between their clients and God, encouraging a lifestyle that reflects gratitude and stewardship for the natural world.

What do Christian Herbalists do?

- Christian herbalists utilize a variety of herbs and plants to address a spectrum of health concerns, ranging from minor issues to chronic conditions. They may formulate herbal remedies such as teas, tinctures, salves, or capsules, and recommend specific herbs for internal consumption or topical application. Additionally, they offer advice on dietary and lifestyle modifications to foster overall wellness and recovery.
- Beyond physical health, Christian herbalists also focus on the spiritual and emotional well-being of their clients. They may provide prayer and spiritual counsel, helping patients connect with God's healing power through the use of herbs and plants.
- Christian herbalists play a vital role in fostering holistic health and wellness, merging the principles of herbalism with Christian teachings. By employing natural remedies and incorporating prayer and scripture into their approach, they assist patients in achieving optimal health across body, mind, and spirit.
- In summary, Christian herbalists are committed to guiding others on their path to health and well-being through the use of herbs and plants, all while being anchored in their faith in God's healing capabilities. If you're interested in exploring herbalism from a Christian viewpoint, consider seeking a Christian herbalist who can offer you tailored care and support on your journey to improved health.
- Whether you're seeking relief from physical ailments, emotional struggles, or spiritual disquiet, a Christian herbalist can provide a compassionate and faith-driven approach to healing. They understand that each individual is uniquely crafted by God, and tailor their practices to honor and support this divine design. In doing so, Christian herbalists not only promote the use of God-given resources found in nature but also emphasize the importance of nurturing one's relationship with God as an integral part of the healing process.
- If you are embarking on this journey, remember that the path to wellness is a collaborative effort between you, your herbalist, and your faith. Embrace the holistic care and wisdom that a Christian herbalist can provide, allowing their guidance to illuminate your path to a healthier, more balanced life. In this way, you are not just treating symptoms but are engaging in a transformative process that seeks to heal the whole person—body, mind, and spirit—through the love and grace of God.

THE CHRISTIAN HERBALIST: NURTURING BODY, MIND, AND SPIRIT

- Christian herbalists are devoted individuals who blend their deep faith in God with a passion for utilizing natural remedies to enhance health and wellness. By merging herbalism with Christian teachings, these practitioners provide a distinctive healing approach that addresses the complete individual – body, mind, and spirit. In this class, we will delve into the role of Christian herbalists in fostering holistic health, the guiding principles they adhere to, and their integration of prayer and scripture in their practice. Christian herbalists view the natural world as a divine gift from God, filled with resources intended to support human health. They believe that by using the plants and herbs God has provided, they can help individuals achieve a harmonious balance in their lives. This holistic approach not only treats physical ailments but also nurtures the emotional and spiritual well-being of their clients.
- A core principle guiding Christian herbalists is the belief that God is the ultimate healer. They see themselves as instruments through which God's healing power can flow, assisting others in their journey towards health and wholeness. This perspective fosters a deep sense of humility and service, as they recognize their role in the larger tapestry of God's creation.
- In practice, Christian herbalists often begin their consultations with prayer, inviting the Holy Spirit to guide their interactions and decisions. This spiritual foundation allows them to discern the specific needs of their clients and tailor their herbal remedies accordingly. Scripture readings may also be incorporated into their sessions, providing spiritual encouragement and grounding.
- Moreover, Christian herbalists emphasize the importance of lifestyle choices that align with biblical teachings. They encourage their clients to adopt practices such as gratitude, forgiveness, and meditation on scripture, which can enhance the healing process and contribute to a balanced life.
- By integrating faith and herbalism, Christian herbalists offer a compassionate and comprehensive approach to health care. They serve as beacons of hope and healing, reminding their clients of the interconnectedness of body, mind, and spirit. Through their work, they honor God's creation and inspire others to cultivate a deeper relationship with Him, promoting a life of wellness and spiritual fulfillment.

THE ROLE OF CHRISTIAN HERBALISTS

- Christian herbalists are essential in promoting holistic health through the use of natural remedies for various ailments. They believe that God has equipped us with all we need to sustain our health, and that by harnessing the power of herbs and plants, we can aid our bodies in self-healing. Often, Christian herbalists collaborate with conventional medical practitioners to create a well-rounded approach to healthcare. By integrating their deep-rooted faith with botanical knowledge, Christian herbalists provide a unique perspective that emphasizes the interconnectedness of body, mind, and spirit. They view the natural world as a testament to God's provision, seeing each plant as a gift with potential healing properties. This belief encourages a respect for nature and a responsibility to use its resources wisely.
- In their practice, Christian herbalists often begin by assessing the individual needs of their clients, considering not only physical symptoms but also emotional and spiritual well-being. They may recommend specific herbs tailored to the person's condition, such as chamomile for relaxation or echinacea to boost immunity, and provide guidance on their safe and effective use. Additionally, they emphasize the importance of lifestyle choices, such as proper nutrition and stress management, as integral components of maintaining health.
- Furthermore, Christian herbalists often incorporate prayer and spiritual counsel into their practice, seeking divine guidance to support their clients' healing journeys. This holistic approach not only addresses physical health but also aims to foster a deeper relationship with God and a greater sense of peace and purpose.
- Ultimately, Christian herbalists serve as compassionate healers who offer a blend of ancient wisdom and spiritual insight, helping individuals achieve a balanced and harmonious state of health. Through their work, they inspire others to see the beauty and potential of God's creation, encouraging a lifestyle that honors both the body and the spirit.

INTEGRATING PRAYER AND SCRIPTURE

- A fundamental aspect of Christian herbalism is the incorporation of prayer and scripture into the healing journey. Christian herbalists believe that by seeking divine guidance and wisdom, they can better discern the needs of their patients and deliver more effective treatments. They frequently pray with their patients prior to administering herbal remedies and may include scripture readings during their consultations.
- Christian herbalists present a distinctive healing model that intertwines herbalism with Christian teachings. By employing natural remedies, embracing prayer and scripture, and recognizing each person as a whole being, Christian herbalists empower their patients to attain optimal health and wellness in body, mind, and spirit. If you are in search of a holistic healthcare approach that acknowledges God as the ultimate healer, consider reaching out to a Christian herbalist today.
- Through their compassionate guidance and holistic care, Christian herbalists offer more than just physical remedies; they provide a pathway to spiritual enrichment and emotional support. By understanding the interconnectedness of body, mind, and spirit, these practitioners help patients to not only overcome health challenges but also to find peace and balance in their lives.
- Christian herbalists encourage patients to embrace a lifestyle that reflects gratitude for the natural world, advocating for sustainable practices and mindful living. They emphasize the importance of nurturing the soul through prayer, meditation, and reflection, fostering a deeper relationship with God as an integral part of the healing process.
- In a world where modern medicine often overlooks the spiritual dimensions of health, Christian herbalists stand as a bridge between tradition and faith, offering a comprehensive approach that honors the Creator's wisdom. Through their work, they inspire others to see health as a gift from God, one that should be cherished and cultivated with love, respect, and faith.
- Whether you are dealing with a specific health issue or seeking to enhance your overall well-being, a Christian herbalist can provide you with personalized guidance and support. Their approach not only aims to heal the body but also to uplift the spirit and renew the mind, helping you to experience a fuller, more vibrant life in harmony with God's creation.

PRINCIPLES OF CHRISTIAN HERBALISM

- Christian herbalists operate under a distinct set of principles that shape their practice. These include honoring God as the ultimate healer, valuing the natural world and its resources, and treating each person as a unique individual with specific needs. Additionally, Christian herbalists hold a strong belief in the power of prayer and the significance of seeking God's guidance in their endeavors. They view the integration of faith and herbal knowledge as a sacred responsibility, ensuring that their practices reflect both spiritual and scientific wisdom. By emphasizing the importance of using herbs with intention and care, Christian herbalists strive to align their treatments with biblical teachings and ethical standards.
- Another key principle is the commitment to education and empowerment. Christian herbalists aim to educate their clients about the benefits and proper use of herbal remedies, fostering self-awareness and encouraging individuals to take an active role in their own health care. This involves sharing knowledge about the properties of various herbs and their potential impacts on the body, always with a focus on safety and efficacy.
- Moreover, Christian herbalists often adopt a holistic approach, considering not just the physical symptoms but also the emotional and spiritual well-being of their clients. They recognize that true healing encompasses the whole person, and thus they incorporate practices that nurture the spirit, such as prayer, meditation, and reflection on scripture.
- In their practice, Christian herbalists also prioritize sustainability and stewardship of the earth. They advocate for the responsible sourcing and use of herbs, understanding that caring for the natural world is an expression of gratitude for God's creation. This involves choosing ethically harvested plants and promoting practices that protect and preserve the environment for future generations.
- In summary, the principles of Christian herbalism are deeply rooted in faith, respect for nature, and a commitment to holistic health. By honoring these principles, Christian herbalists seek to offer compassionate care that reflects the love and grace of God, helping individuals to achieve balance and wholeness in their lives.

BIBLICAL EXAMPLES OF HERBS

The Bible provides us with many examples of good food choices that can help us achieve optimal health. Here are 10 healing foods from the Bible that you can add to your diet:

1. Throughout the Bible, small fruits like figs, grapes, and pomegranates were used widely in beverages, cakes, or eaten as fresh fruit themselves.
    a. Pomegranates: Rich in antioxidants, vitamins, and minerals, pomegranates are a great source of nutrition that can help keep your body healthy and vibrant. Pomegranates have high anti-inflammatory, antioxidant, and even anti-tumor properties.
    b. Figs: Rich in fiber, vitamins, and minerals, figs are a delicious and nutritious fruit that can help maintain healthy blood pressure and lower the risk of heart disease. Loaded with minerals and vitamins like Vitamin A, K, and E, fresh figs are also low in calories and high in fiber.
    c. Grapes: contain resveratrol, a powerful antioxidant known for guarding against colon and prostate cancer as well as reducing stroke risk.
2. Honey: Known for its antibacterial properties, honey is not only a great natural sweetener, but it can also help fight infections and promote healing. Raw honey was a highly valued asset in the Bible. When God gave the Israelite people their promised land, it was described as a land flowing with milk and honey—a fertile agricultural area that could produce amazing foods, including bees with raw honey. Not only was honey nutritious and filling, but it was also a valued gift and a sweet metaphor for God's Word. Psalm 119:103 NIV describes how sweet God's words are to the taste, even sweeter than honey to the mouth.
3. Olive oil: High in healthy fats and antioxidants, olive oil is a staple in the Mediterranean diet and can help reduce inflammation and protect against chronic diseases. Olive oil was plentiful in Bible times due to the abundant crop of olive trees that continue to bear fruit even into old age. The Garden of Gethsemane, where Jesus prayed for God's will to be done the night before His crucifixion, is known for its gnarled, twisted olive trees. Green olives produced the best fruit and oil. Olives made delicious side dishes pickled or in a relish. The versatile, pressed olive oil was used in baking bread as well as in a salve for wounds, softening skin, in lamps, or even as a sacred anointing oil for kings.
4. Fish: Rich in omega-3 fatty acids, fish is a great source of protein that can help reduce inflammation and improve heart health. Fish is a highly nutritious food that was highly valued in biblical times. In fact, God specified in Leviticus 11:9 TLB that people could eat any fish with fins and scales, whether from rivers or seas. Additionally, fish was a staple in Jesus' day, and at least seven of His disciples were fishermen. On various occasions, He ate fish with His disciples and performed two miracles using a boy's lunch of small fish and bread loaves to feed thousands of people.
5. Vegetables: The Bible is full of references to vegetables, and for good reason. Vegetables are loaded with vitamins, minerals, and fiber, and can help protect against a variety of chronic diseases.
    a. Garlic: With its powerful anti-inflammatory and antibacterial properties, garlic is a versatile ingredient that can be used in many dishes to improve both taste and health.
6. Sprouted Grains and Breads In the Bible, bread appears repeatedly as the substance of life. Jesus even referred to Himself as the "Bread of Life." The bread in Bible times used none of the modern and damaging refining methods of today. The kind of nutritious bread they served often involved the sprouting of natural grains and was a basic part of their diets. Whole grain sourdough and sprouted-grain breads involve the soaking or fermenting of grains overnight until the seeds are partially sprouted. This process actually makes these carbohydrates more easily digestible.

BIBLICAL EXAMPLES OF HERBS

7. Goat Milk and Products Raw goat milk and cheese were plentiful in Bible times and were not pasteurized like our modern food. More easily digestible than cow's milk, goat's milk also has less lactose and contains multiple vitamins, enzymes, and proteins. According to Jordan Rubin, 65% of the world's population drinks goat's milk. It can help in the treatment of inflammatory diseases, is a complete protein, and is also useful in soaps.

8. Beans and Lentils Beans or lentils (legumes) were served widely in the Old Testament, probably since they are such good sources of protein. Legumes are plentiful in folate, especially important to pregnant women, are good antioxidants, and are low in saturated fats.

Lentils: A great source of protein, fiber, and complex carbohydrates, lentils are a nutritious food that can help regulate blood sugar levels and promote digestive health.

9. Nuts Pistachio and almond nuts, both found in the Bible, are low-calorie snacks. Pistachio nuts are high as antioxidants and contain more lutein (1000%) than other nuts. Almonds, mentioned several times in the Bible, are one of the highest protein and fiber nuts and contain manganese, magnesium, and calcium, necessary ingredients for the body.

Almonds: High in protein, healthy fats, and antioxidants, almonds are a great snack that can help reduce inflammation and support brain function.

10. Flax Flax was used with linen in the Bible to make clothes. But it also had great medicinal value because of its high fiber, Omega-3 fatty acids, protein, and lignan count. It contains one of the highest plant sources of lignans, almost 800 times more than any other. These help as antioxidants, in maintaining blood sugar, cholesterol, and even in cancer prevention.

Spices, Seasonings, and Herbs In the Old and New Testament, scores of spices were used as both food and medicines, as well as in making perfumes or incense, and were given as expensive, royal gifts. Cinnamon, known for its aromatic fragrance, as a spice has one of the highest antioxidant values known. Garlic is often linked to helping heart and immune issues. Other spices of the Bible include coriander, frankincense, mint, dill, balm, aloes, myrrh, and rue. Each contained healing properties such as promoting digestion, aiding the immune system, relieving pain, or fighting infections.

Incorporating these healing foods into your diet can help you achieve optimal health and wellness. Additionally, it is important to eat "grass-fed" and organic products to protect from harmful antibiotics or pesticides. By honoring God's wisdom and using these foods, we can keep our bodies healthy as temples of the Holy Ghost.

Herbs & their Uses

God has placed thousands of plants on Earth. You just need to know how to use them, and it is my hope to teach you exactly that! I want to inspire you to try some of the herbs and spices you will learn about today. God's plants aid and support the body processes that God designed. The plant-derived "medicine" you read about today was discussed eons ago in biblical times. The herbs from the Scriptures have medicinal phytonutrients (constituents). I believe that we can achieve optimal wellness with what God provided for us from the beginning.

Genesis 1:29

"And God said, Behold, I have given you every herb bearing seed, which is upon the face of all the earth, and every tree, in the which is the fruit of a tree yielding seed; to you it shall be for meat." King James Version (KJV)

Herb Studies

ALMOND

- ALMOND Prunus dulcis
- Genesis 43:11, Numbers 17
- Almonds are a type of nut that has been cultivated for thousands of years and are enjoyed all around the world. They are a nutritious food that offers a range of health benefits. Almonds contain salicin, which is a natural compound that can be converted into salicylic acid, the primary byproduct of aspirin metabolization. Aspirin is commonly used to relieve headaches and pain. Anecdotal evidence suggests that regular consumption of almonds might have a cumulative pain relief effect on headache and pain sufferers.
- In addition to their potential pain-relieving properties, almonds have also been mentioned in the Bible in both Genesis 43:11 and Numbers 17. In the former, the father of Israel instructs his sons to take "a little balm, and a little honey, spices, and myrrh, nuts, and almonds" as a present. In the latter, the rod of Aaron for the house of Levi was budded, and brought forth buds, and bloomed blossoms, and yielded almonds.
- But almonds are not just a historical or anecdotal food. In recent years, several studies have been conducted on the health benefits of almonds. A recent study published in The Journal of Nutrition found that almonds can decrease postprandial (after eating) blood sugar, as well as insulin and oxidative damage. This is great news for people who are looking for ways to improve their blood sugar levels, especially those with diabetes or pre-diabetes.
- In another clinical trial, researchers studied 60 male smokers who ate just 3 ounces of almonds every day for four weeks. The results showed that the participants had a significant reduction in oxidative stress biomarkers, ranging from 23 to 34 percent. This indicates that almonds could be an effective way to combat oxidative damage, which is a major contributor to chronic diseases like cancer, heart disease, and Alzheimer's disease.
- Beyond these specific health benefits, almonds are a rich source of nutrients that are essential for overall health and wellbeing. Almonds are a good source of protein, fiber, healthy fats, and vitamin E, which is an important antioxidant that helps protect cells from damage caused by free radicals. Additionally, almonds are a good source of magnesium, which is important for bone health, and potassium, which helps regulate blood pressure.
- Based on this research and other studies that have been conducted on almonds, many nutrition experts consider them to be a superfood. They are often ranked up there with other nutrient-dense foods like colorful berries and leafy greens. So, if you're looking for a healthy snack or a way to add more nutrients to your diet, consider adding some almonds to your daily routine. However, as with any food, it is important to consume them in moderation as part of a balanced diet.
- Almonds are a versatile food that can be enjoyed in many ways. They can be eaten raw, roasted, or salted and make a great addition to salads, smoothies, baked goods, and more. You can also make your own almond milk or almond butter at home for a delicious and healthy alternative to dairy or peanut butter.
- While almonds are generally safe to eat, it is important to note that they do contain oxalates, which can contribute to kidney stones in some people. If you have a history of kidney stones or other kidney problems, it is important to discuss your almond consumption with your healthcare provider.
- In conclusion, almonds are a delicious and nutritious food that can provide a range of health benefits when consumed as part of a balanced diet. Whether you snack on them throughout the day or use them as a versatile ingredient in your cooking and baking, almonds are a great way to add more nutrients to your diet and improve your overall health. So go ahead and enjoy some almonds today!

ALOE

ALOE
Aquilara malaccensis
John 19:39, Proverbs 7:17, Psalm 45:8, Song of Solomon 4:14

The Bible mentions aloe several times, but it differs from the spiky plant typically associated with soothing cuts and minor wounds. In biblical times, this form of aloe was also known as aloes, lign-aloes, aloeswood, and agarwood, which are quite distinct from the household aloe plant.

Aloes comes from the Aquilaria tree, an evergreen native to northern India and Southeast Asia. This valuable resin or gum is produced by the tree as a natural defense against pathogens like fungi. The resin forms in response to injuries sustained by the tree, believed to trigger an "infection" that encourages the growth of oleoresin within the heartwood of Aquilaria.

Historically, this type of aloe was often given as a gift alongside myrrh, cassia (cinnamon), and various aromatic spices used to scent clothing and linens, as mentioned in Psalms 45:8. The Egyptians also utilized it in the embalming process for their deceased. Over the centuries, it has been used as incense, perfume, and in traditional medicine practices such as Ayurveda and Chinese medicine. John 19:39 notes that Nicodemus brought it along with myrrh to prepare the Lord's body for burial.

Traditionally, it has been used to relieve pain and diseases related to inflammation. In modern China, aloeswood is employed to alleviate nausea and vomiting associated with chemotherapy. Research in Traditional Chinese Medicine (TCM) suggests its efficacy in loosening phlegm and addressing gastrointestinal stagnation or toxicity linked to chemotherapy. One reason aloes or agarwood essential oil may reduce pain and inflammation is its ability to diminish and eliminate cancer cells. Despite its name similarity to aloe vera, this ancient essential oil from the Aquilaria tree is significantly different and continues to hold immense value today. It was once so rare that it was considered worth its weight in gold and remains a luxury item in the East.Aloeswood's distinct, rich aroma has captivated many cultures, leading to its use in various religious and spiritual practices. Its scent is often described as complex and deep, with earthy, woody, and slightly sweet undertones. This has made it a sought-after ingredient in high-end perfumes and incense.

In addition to its aromatic properties, aloeswood has been attributed with several spiritual and therapeutic benefits. Many believe it possesses the power to enhance meditation, promote a sense of peace, and facilitate a deeper connection to the spiritual realm. In traditional practices, it is thought to cleanse spaces of negative energy and invite tranquility and clarity of mind.

The harvesting of aloeswood is both an art and a science, as the quality and fragrance of the resin depend on specific environmental conditions and the tree's age. Due to its rarity and the complexity involved in its cultivation and extraction, sustainable practices are being developed to preserve this valuable resource for future generations.

- Today, aloeswood continues to be treasured not only for its historical and cultural significance but also for its enduring ability to soothe, heal, and inspire. Whether used in traditional medicine, spiritual rituals, or as a luxurious fragrance, aloeswood remains a symbol of nature's profound and mysterious gifts.

ANISE

Anise, scientifically known as Pimpinella anisum, is a flowering plant in the family Apiaceae. In the King James Version (KJV) of the Bible, anise is mentioned in Matthew 23:23, where it is listed among the spices that the Pharisees are criticized for tithing while neglecting more important matters of the law.

Benefits of anise include:

1. **Digestive Health**: Anise is commonly used to relieve digestive issues such as bloating, gas, and indigestion. Its carminative properties help soothe the gastrointestinal tract.
2. **Antimicrobial Properties**: Anise has been shown to possess antibacterial and antifungal properties, which can help protect against various infections.
3. **Hormonal Balance**: Anise may help in balancing hormones due to its phytoestrogen content, which can be beneficial for women experiencing menstrual discomfort or menopause symptoms.
4. **Respiratory Health**: The expectorant properties of anise can help alleviate symptoms of respiratory conditions by loosening mucus and soothing the throat.
5. **Anti-inflammatory Effects**: Anise contains compounds that may reduce inflammation in the body, potentially benefiting conditions like arthritis.

Nutritionally, anise is a source of several key nutrients and phytochemicals, including:

- **Essential Oils**: Anise oil contains anethole, which is responsible for its distinctive flavor and many of its health benefits.
- **Vitamins**: Anise is a source of vitamins such as vitamin C and B vitamins (including B6, B9, and riboflavin).
- **Minerals**: It provides minerals like calcium, iron, magnesium, and manganese.
- **Phytochemicals**: Besides anethole, anise contains flavonoids and other antioxidants that contribute to its health benefits.
- Overall, anise is a flavorful herb with a variety of health benefits and important nutrients that can support overall wellness.

BLACK CUMIN

- *BLACK CUMIN**
- *Nigella sativa**
- *Isaiah 28:23**

Black cumin, or Nigella sativa, is typically sown in winter and harvested by early summer, yielding its distinctive black seeds. These seeds possess a unique flavor, often enhancing the taste of breads and various baked goods. The Bible references the traditional method of threshing these seeds by striking the dried plants with a stick (Isaiah 28:28).

It is crucial to note that black cumin is distinct from regular cumin; not only do they differ in appearance, but they also present unique flavors. Incorporating black cumin into your diet can be beneficial, or you may consider softgel supplements containing "Black Cumin Seed" oil, which is believed to offer health advantages throughout the body.

Research suggests that the compounds found in black cumin can aid in reducing blood sugar levels and improving beta cell function in the pancreas, potentially benefiting those with diabetes. Additionally, one study indicates that it may decrease seizure frequency in children who are resistant to drug therapy, highlighting its significant anti-convulsant properties.

Furthermore, black cumin seed has shown promising results in treating MRSA, a dangerous antibiotic-resistant bacterial infection, with patients responding positively to this treatment. Regarding its effects on cancer, a study published in the journal PLoS One reveals that a compound known as "thymoquinone," derived from black seed, may induce tumor cell death in glioblastoma cells—one of the most aggressive forms of brain cancer. Similar benefits have been observed in cases of oral and breast cancer.

In addition to these remarkable health benefits, black cumin is renowned for its powerful antioxidant properties, which help protect cells from damage caused by free radicals. This contributes to overall health and wellness by supporting the immune system and reducing inflammation throughout the body.

Historically, black cumin seed oil has been utilized in traditional medicine for centuries to address various ailments, ranging from digestive issues to respiratory conditions. Its versatility makes it a valuable addition to any natural health regimen.

For those interested in incorporating black cumin into their daily routine, it can be utilized in several ways. The seeds may be sprinkled on salads, blended into smoothies, or added to spice mixes for an exotic flavor. Alternatively, the oil can be consumed in capsule form or applied topically to promote healthy skin and hair.

- As with any supplement, it is advisable to consult with a healthcare provider before adding black cumin to your regimen, particularly if you have underlying health conditions or are taking other medications. With its rich history and promising potential, black cumin remains a compelling subject of study and a valued element of holistic health practices.

BLACK CUMIN

- *Bitter Herbs**
- Exodus 12:8; Numbers 9:11*

If you've recently enjoyed a fresh salad abundant with leafy greens, you may have encountered plants known as bitter herbs. Common examples include romaine lettuce and horseradish, which lend a distinctive 'biblical' note to your Caesar salad. Other varieties of bitter herbs include endive, green onions, and parsley. During the first Passover, as recounted in Exodus, the Jewish people consumed these bitter herbs alongside unleavened bread and lamb.

The notable 'bite' experienced when consuming horseradish, scientifically known as *Armoracia rusticana*, is due to compounds that provide antioxidants and support detoxification. Additionally, horseradish stimulates saliva production and enhances digestive enzyme activity, thereby improving digestion. It is also a rich source of vitamin C and several essential minerals, including potassium, manganese, iron, copper, magnesium, zinc, and sodium.

Moreover, horseradish root contains B vitamins and an enzyme called horseradish peroxidase, recognized for its potent reactivity to cancer cells. Research has investigated the effects of horseradish peroxidase, particularly when combined with indole-3-acetic acid (a plant-derived compound), on various types of cancer, including nasopharyngeal, bladder, and breast cancers.

Another significant bitter herb is *Lactuca sativa*, or romaine lettuce. The most bitter portion of romaine is its tips, which are nutrient-dense whether juiced or incorporated into salads and wraps. In fact, romaine lettuce is more nutritious than many common leafy greens, especially when compared to iceberg lettuce. Its darker coloration indicates a higher chlorophyll content, contributing to its nutrient density.

Romaine lettuce is abundant in essential nutrients, such as calcium, iron, magnesium, potassium, vitamin C, folate, and various B vitamins, all of which play vital roles in the methylation and transmethylation detoxification pathways.

- Among all common lettuces, romaine boasts the highest folate content. Folate is crucial for life, as it contributes to proper DNA formation in unborn children and is essential for pregnant women. It supports the healthy production of red blood cells and the immune system's function. Without the nutrients provided by bitter herbs like romaine, aspects such as energy production, mood regulation, cognition, sleep quality, and physical strength may be compromised. Given the arduous journey the Israelites were about to undertake following Passover, the consumption of bitter herbs was vital for their endurance and well-being.

CUMIN

*Cumin (Cuminum cyminum)**
*Referenced in Isaiah 28:28**
Cumin, a member of the parsley family, was a cherished spice in biblical times. The seeds, botanically classified as fruits, possess a warm and slightly bitter flavor that enhances a diverse array of dishes, including cheeses, soups, sauces (such as tandoori and taco sauce), and curries. Medicinally, cumin is recognized for its potent antibiotic properties and its role as a digestive aid.

This spice is significant in gene function, particularly due to its high content of essential minerals like iron and manganese. These minerals serve as crucial cofactors that support vital metabolic processes within the body. For example, iron is necessary for the breakdown of hydrogen peroxide, while manganese is also required for this function. A deficiency in either mineral can lead to a hazardous accumulation of peroxide, resulting in pain, inflammation, and elevated thyroid peroxidase (TPO) antibodies, which can adversely affect thyroid function.

Research suggests that cumin may stimulate pancreatic enzymes and enhance insulin sensitivity. In studies involving diabetic animals, cumin extract demonstrated greater efficacy in lowering blood glucose levels and reducing advanced glycation end products (AGE) compared to glyburide (or glibenclamide), a common diabetes medication. Further animal studies indicate that cumin may also be beneficial in the treatment of cataracts. Additional research hints at cumin's potential to lower cholesterol, triglycerides, and markers of pancreatic inflammation. This raises the question: Could cumin consumption be advantageous for individuals with diabetes? It appears that it could be.

Cumin is a powerful antioxidant and may also assist those suffering from asthma by acting as a bronchodilator. For individuals experiencing episodes of respiratory distress, this natural spice may provide significant relief. It can be consumed through foods or taken in supplemental forms rather than being inhaled. Furthermore, cumin's anti-inflammatory properties may be instrumental in managing conditions such as arthritis, where inflammation is a primary concern. By incorporating cumin into daily meals or as a supplement, individuals may discover a natural method to alleviate joint discomfort and promote overall joint health.

Beyond its health benefits, cumin's culinary versatility is widely appreciated. Culinary enthusiasts value its ability to add depth and complexity to a variety of dishes. Whether sprinkled on roasted vegetables, mixed into marinades for grilled meats, or blended into spice mixes like garam masala, cumin contributes a distinctive warmth and earthiness that enhances the flavor profile of meals.

Additionally, cumin can be incorporated into sweet dishes, particularly in Middle Eastern and Indian desserts, where its unique flavor offers an unexpected yet delightful twist. Exploring cumin in unconventional culinary contexts can lead to delightful discoveries, making it a spice worth exploring for both its health advantages and its versatility in the kitchen.

CINNAMON

- *Cinnamon**
- Cinnamomum aromaticum*
- *References:** Exodus 30:23, Ezekiel 27, Proverbs 7:17, Psalm 45, Revelation 18:13

Cinnamon and cassia are derived from closely related plants, though they are not identical. Cassia, scientifically known as *Cinnamomum aromaticum*, has become relatively rare, necessitating sourcing from specialty spice shops. In biblical times, it was considered more valuable than gold in certain regions. The variety commonly found in the majority of households today is *Cinnamomum zelandicum*.

Ezekiel 27 identifies cassia as a trade commodity, while Psalm 45 describes the anointing of the King's garments with cassia alongside myrrh. Furthermore, Proverbs 7:17 states: "I have perfumed my bed with myrrh, aloes, and cinnamon." Presently, grocery stores offer a commercial version that features a delightful, robust flavor reminiscent of autumn and winter.

In contemporary contexts, cinnamon serves various purposes, including the treatment of athlete's foot, alleviation of indigestion, enhancement of cognitive function, and reduction of blood glucose levels. From a medicinal perspective, it is recognized for its potential to support diabetes management and lower blood sugar levels. Notably, most studies examining cinnamon's effects on blood sugar focus on the variety available in supermarkets and health food stores, rather than cassia.

A recent clinical trial involving 109 participants with Type 2 diabetes revealed that those consuming cinnamon experienced a modest reduction in hemoglobin A1c, a critical blood sugar marker. Additionally, a smaller study indicated that individuals with Type 2 diabetes who incorporated 1/4 to 1/2 teaspoon of cinnamon into their daily diet saw a reduction in fasting blood sugar levels by approximately 29 percent. Moreover, cinnamon may positively impact hypertension and cholesterol levels.

Incorporating cinnamon into your meals can enhance both flavor and health benefits; it can be sprinkled on hot chocolate, coffee, oatmeal, and barbecue dishes, providing an effortless means to enrich taste and wellness. Beyond its culinary uses, cinnamon's warm, aromatic scent renders it a popular ingredient in perfumes and candles, evoking comfort and nostalgia. Many associate the fragrance of cinnamon with the festive season, as it is a staple in holiday treats such as cinnamon rolls, spiced apple cider, and gingerbread cookies.

Cinnamon also plays a role in various cultural practices and traditions. In certain cultures, it is utilized in spiritual rituals for protection and prosperity, while its perceived aphrodisiac properties make it a favored choice in love spells and potions.

From a sustainability perspective, cinnamon farming supports thousands of smallholder farmers globally. Ethical sourcing practices ensure that these farmers receive fair compensation and work under safe conditions, thus contributing to the well-being of their communities.

Incorporating cinnamon into your lifestyle, whether through culinary endeavors or holistic practices, offers a delightful way to engage with its rich history and diverse benefits. As you explore the myriad uses of this remarkable spice, you will find that it adds warmth and wellness to your daily experiences.

FIGS

- *Figs (Ficus carica)**
- *References:** Jeremiah 24:2, 1 Samuel 30:12, 2 Kings 20:7, Isaiah 38:21

Originating from the Middle East and western Asia, the fig tree has served as a vital food source since ancient times. Numerous biblical references underscore its significance as nourishment, alongside the medicinal and practical uses of its leaves. Figs grow on the Ficus tree, a member of the mulberry family, with evidence of their utilization dating back to approximately 9400 BC. As stated in Jeremiah 24:2:

"One basket had very good figs, like those that ripen early; the other basket had very bad figs, so bad they could not be eaten."

Figs are known for their numerous seeds, which contribute to their high fiber content and help to suppress hunger. They are also rich in vitamins B5 and B6, as well as minerals such as copper, potassium, and manganese.

The color variations of figs result from potent phytochemicals known as oligoproanthocyanidins (OPCs) or antioxidants. The ripeness of the fig correlates with its antioxidant levels. Research published in the *Chemistry Pharmacological Bulletin* in 2015 indicates that figs contain triterpenoids, recognized for their strong anticancer properties. Biblical texts suggest that figs were commonly incorporated into cakes and served to warriors for sustenance after battles or long journeys. This fruit has been demonstrated to stabilize blood sugar levels and support healthy energy.

Scripture also highlights additional benefits of figs. The fruit is nutritionally valuable, while the leaves of the fig tree possess their own benefits. The Bible mentions a remedy involving a lump of figs, prepared into a paste or plaster, which was applied to treat boils. Historical accounts reveal that Hippocrates employed fig leaves to address skin ulcers and wounds.

Modern studies have explored extracts from fig leaves, revealing their potential to enhance insulin sensitivity, improve kidney function, and assist in liver detoxification. Some test tube experiments have shown that fig leaves can inhibit the growth of certain cancer cells, while animal studies indicate a reduction in triglyceride levels. Personally, I relish figs as soon as they are in season; they are delightful when sliced and served atop a cracker with fresh chèvre cheese.

Figs have long been a staple in various culinary traditions, transcending their ancient origins to remain a cherished ingredient in contemporary kitchens. Their natural sweetness and unique texture make them a versatile addition to a wide range of dishes, from savory to sweet. When paired with a soft cheese like chèvre, the creamy and tangy flavors complement the fig's sweetness, creating a delightful harmony that is both visually appealing and delicious.

Beyond their culinary uses, figs continue to captivate researchers and health enthusiasts alike. The ongoing investigation into their health benefits reveals promising potential for figs in promoting overall wellness. As more individuals seek natural and holistic health solutions, figs emerge as a fruit that offers both a rich historical context and modern relevance, bridging traditional wisdom with contemporary science. Whether enjoyed fresh, dried, or incorporated into jams and baked goods, figs stand as a testament to nature's bounty, celebrated for their flavor, nutritional profile, and enduring legacy.

FRANKINCENSE

*FRANKINCENSE**
*Boswellia serrata**
Exodus 30:34, Leviticus 2:1, 2:15, Matthew 2:11, Song of Solomon 3:6

During the holiday season, we reflect on one of the most celebrated gifts in history: gold, frankincense, and myrrh, presented by the Magi. If we were to journey back to those ancient times, it would be evident that these precious items were intended to honor a king or deity. Gold has long been revered as a valuable metal, frankincense was utilized in perfumes and incense, while myrrh served as an anointing oil in burials and significant religious ceremonies.

So, what precisely is frankincense? Unlike most herbal supplements derived from leaves or berries, frankincense is a resinous substance. It forms when the sap of the Boswellia tree oozes out, creating small white droplets that harden and turn yellow upon exposure to air. These hardened droplets are often burned for their pleasing fragrance.

Christian scholars and biblical theologians have contemplated the choice of frankincense among the gifts of the Magi. What was its significance? Was it intended to alleviate any future discomfort for Jesus? While this may seem improbable, researchers from Cardiff University in Wales have been exploring the medicinal properties of frankincense and propose that this notion may hold merit.

Their comprehensive research has verified that frankincense contains compounds capable of alleviating arthritis by reducing inflammation that damages cartilage tissue, thereby causing pain. Their recent study supports the traditional use of frankincense as a remedy for joint pain and inflammation in communities across North Africa and the Arabian Peninsula, where these trees flourish. Boswellia is frequently studied for its efficacy in relieving joint pain, functioning similarly to prescription anti-inflammatories. Did the Magi recognize the healing attributes of frankincense when they presented it to Jesus? It was highly valued in ancient times, just as it is today, though it is now commonly referred to by its scientific name, "Boswellia." It is available in various forms, including dietary supplements designed to mimic the effects of prescription medications like Celebrex or Ibuprofen, as well as essential oils and powdered forms, which I procure from my local apothecary for personal use.

In my household, I frequently diffuse frankincense and myrrh in my bedroom using an essential oil diffuser. This process is simple—just add 3 to 5 drops to water and plug the diffuser into the wall. It will release a pleasant aroma into your space for several hours. The calming and soothing properties of frankincense oil promote deeper breathing, significantly enhancing mood and overall wellness, particularly as many of us tend to hold our breath.

Research indicates that Boswellia may inhibit the growth of certain cancers in laboratory studies. In 2009, researchers investigated the effects of AKBA, or "acetyl-11-keto-beta-boswellic acid," yielding promising results. This study, titled *Frankincense Superior to Chemotherapy in Killing Late-Stage Ovarian Cancer Cells*, is not the only one suggesting potential anti-cancer properties. Another study demonstrated that frankincense oil could assist in treating bladder cancer, concluding that "frankincense oil might represent an alternative intravesical agent for bladder cancer treatment." Furthermore, research suggests that boswellia essential oil may possess the ability to disrupt biofilms associated with resistant staphylococcal infections, candida, and other pathogens.

GARLIC

GARLIC
Allium sativum
Numbers 11.5
Garlic is referenced in the Bible during the Israelites' journey through the desert after their escape from Egypt. They reminisced about the delicious foods they enjoyed in Egypt, which included garlic, melons, onions, and leeks. This flavorful herb was utilized by Ancient Egyptians for both culinary and medicinal applications. For thousands of years, it has remained a fundamental ingredient in the Mediterranean region.

Garlic is renowned for its numerous health benefits, largely attributed to its rich content of phytonutrients and essential nutrients. Here's a breakdown of what garlic contains and the scientific findings related to its benefits:

Phytonutrients in Garlic:

1. **Allicin**: This is the most notable compound in garlic, formed when garlic is crushed or chopped. Allicin has antimicrobial and anti-inflammatory properties.
2. **S-allyl cysteine**: An antioxidant that helps reduce oxidative stress and may protect against certain types of cancer.
3. **Diallyl sulfide**: Known for its potential anti-cancer properties and ability to enhance the immune system.
4. **Flavonoids**: Garlic contains various flavonoids, which are known for their antioxidant effects.
5. **Organosulfur compounds**: These compounds are responsible for many of garlic's health benefits, including cardiovascular health.

Nutritional Content of Garlic:

- **Vitamins**: Garlic is a source of vitamins C and B6.
- **Minerals**: It contains minerals such as manganese, calcium, phosphorus, and selenium.
- **Fiber**: Garlic also provides some dietary fiber, which is beneficial for digestive health.
- **Calories**: It is low in calories, making it a healthy addition to various dishes.

Scientific Studies on the Benefits of Garlic:

1. **Cardiovascular Health**: Numerous studies suggest that garlic can help reduce blood pressure and cholesterol levels, contributing to better heart health. A meta-analysis published in "The Journal of Nutrition" indicated that garlic supplementation significantly lowered systolic and diastolic blood pressure in hypertensive patients.
2. **Immune System Support**: Research has shown that garlic can enhance the immune response. A study published in the "American Journal of Clinical Nutrition" found that garlic supplementation reduced the incidence of colds.
3. **Antimicrobial Properties**: Garlic has been shown to possess antimicrobial effects against various pathogens. Studies have highlighted its effectiveness against bacteria, viruses, and fungi.
4. **Cancer Prevention**: Several epidemiological studies suggest that regular consumption of garlic may be linked to a lower risk of certain cancers, particularly stomach and colorectal cancers. The compounds in garlic are believed to have protective effects against cancer cells.
5. **Antioxidant Effects**: Garlic's phytonutrients exhibit strong antioxidant properties, which help combat oxidative stress and may reduce the risk of chronic diseases.

Overall, incorporating garlic into your diet can provide a range of health benefits, supported by scientific research.

MARJORAM

MARJORAM
Marjorana hortensis
Leviticus 14:4

Marjoram is often surrounded by confusion due to a misclassification as oregano in the 18th century, and its misinterpretation as "hyssop" in the Holy Bible, which refers to another biblical herb. However, true marjoram has been utilized for centuries and is sometimes placed at gravesides to help a departed loved one find peace. Interestingly, it is also woven into bridal wreaths, symbolizing love and honor.

Rich in powerful compounds such as ursolic acid, thymol, and carvacrol, marjoram boasts strong antioxidant properties that support digestion. It stimulates the release of pepsin, a naturally occurring "proteolytic" enzyme found in gastric juice, which aids in breaking down proteins from meat, eggs, seeds, and dairy into smaller peptides. Remarkably, marjoram can enhance pepsin production by as much as 30 percent.

For those concerned about strokes or heart attacks, sprinkling marjoram on food can be beneficial. It acts similarly to aspirin as a natural, mild blood thinner, reducing platelet stickiness and promoting better blood flow through vessels. Research indicates it can decrease the clumping of blood components that lead to dangerous clots by 40 percent, making it a smart choice for individuals with cardiovascular issues.

Additionally, marjoram may help slow the progression of Alzheimer's disease by boosting levels of acetylcholine, a crucial memory molecule. In an animal study published in the Journal of Neuroimmunology, ursolic acid showed potential in alleviating some symptoms of experimental autoimmune myasthenia gravis. Marjoram could also be useful for treating gum or tooth infections. As a sleep aid, consider adding a few drops to an essential oil diffuser during sleepless nights or times of nervous tension. You can also apply it to your hands and feet or enjoy a relaxing bath with five drops in the water.

Culturally, marjoram has been a symbol of peace and harmony. It has been incorporated into various rituals and ceremonies to promote reconciliation and friendship, further enhancing its reputation as a plant of goodwill and positive energy. It is often used in aromatherapy to create a calming atmosphere, helping to alleviate stress and anxiety with its soothing aroma.

In the kitchen, marjoram adds a delicate, sweet flavor to a variety of dishes, from soups and stews to salads and sauces. Its versatility makes it a favorite among chefs and home cooks alike, who appreciate its ability to enhance the flavors of both savory and sweet recipes.

Whether you are seeking its health benefits, spiritual symbolism, or culinary charm, marjoram remains a timeless herb that continues to enrich our lives in countless ways.

MILK THISTLE

MILK THISTLE
Silybum marianum
Genesis 3:18

This well-known herb is also known as Holy Thistle and Blessed Thistle. It is associated with the Virgin Mary, based on the belief that her milk once dripped onto its leaves. The plant can grow tall, reaching up to about 4 feet.
From Genesis 3:18:
"It will produce thorns and thistles for you, and you will eat the plants of the field. But Jehoash king of Israel replied to Amaziah king of Judah: 'A thistle in Lebanon sent a message to a cedar in Lebanon, "Give your daughter to my son in marriage."' Then a wild beast in Lebanon came along and trampled the thistle underfoot."
Milk thistle is an herb that supports liver health, particularly beneficial for those who are unwell, have overeaten, suffered from food poisoning, or are dealing with alcohol-related liver issues. The liver, the second-largest organ after the skin, is well-protected by milk thistle, which may even help in cases of exposure to Amanita mushrooms. While this situation is rare, milk thistle can also protect your liver from damage caused by analgesics like acetaminophen or paracetamol (commonly known as Tylenol).
Among the many active compounds in milk thistle, silymarin is noteworthy. This component helps repair liver cells damaged by alcohol by promoting the production of proteins that modify the outer layer of liver cells. Consequently, toxins are kept out, fostering the growth of healthier liver cells.
Silymarin encourages liver cell regeneration, making it a popular herb for hepatitis. It boosts bile production and may aid with digestive concerns. However, caution is advised, as it can have estrogen-like effects that might lead to estrogen dominance (progesterone deficiency). In women, it may stimulate milk production during breastfeeding and could help trigger a delayed menstrual cycle. Some experts believe that milk thistle's estrogen-like properties might benefit prostate cancer, but consulting your oncologist is crucial beforehand. Furthermore, milk thistle has been studied for its antioxidant and anti-inflammatory effects, which enhance its liver protection. By reducing inflammation, it may help prevent liver fibrosis and cirrhosis, conditions that can lead to liver failure if untreated.
In addition to supporting liver health, milk thistle is occasionally used to help manage blood sugar levels in individuals with type 2 diabetes, as some studies suggest it may enhance insulin sensitivity. Its antioxidant properties can also guard against oxidative stress, which is associated with chronic diseases like heart disease and cancer.
The herb is generally regarded as safe when taken in recommended amounts, although some individuals may experience mild side effects, such as gastrointestinal discomfort or allergic reactions. As with any supplement, it's essential to consult a healthcare provider before starting milk thistle, especially if you are pregnant, nursing, or taking other medications, to avoid possible interactions.
In summary, milk thistle is a multifaceted herb with a rich history of medicinal use. Its benefits extend beyond liver support, offering potential advantages for digestive health, hormonal balance, and more. As research progresses, milk thistle may uncover even more health-promoting properties, reinforcing its significance in the realm of natural medicine.

MINT

- *MINT**
- Mentha piperita*
- Matthew 23:23*

Mint, particularly its active component menthol, is widely recognized for its presence in various topical muscle-relief ointments. The compounds found in natural mint leaves can aid digestive health, making it a valuable option for individuals with Irritable Bowel Syndrome (IBS) and Small Intestine Bacterial Overgrowth (SIBO). For these conditions, enteric-coated peppermint oil capsules are advisable, as they allow the oil to bypass stomach acid and reach the intestines, where it acts as an antimicrobial agent. These specialized capsules are essential because they dissolve in the intestines rather than the stomach. However, individuals experiencing heartburn or reflux should avoid peppermint.

In addition to its digestive benefits, peppermint can alleviate symptoms associated with colds and flu, such as congestion, headaches, muscle pain, nausea, and fever. Enjoying a warm cup of peppermint tea or diffusing the essential oil in a sickroom can help eliminate germs. Furthermore, when diluted in a carrier oil like almond oil, peppermint oil can be applied to the throat or chest. It also enhances the experience of a foot bath or a regular bath.

For those who have undergone chemotherapy and are experiencing hot flashes, a small study in the United Kingdom suggested that a peppermint oil solution might mitigate hot flashes resulting from breast cancer treatment. While the exact formula for this spray is not available, a mixture of approximately 15 drops of peppermint oil in 4 ounces of distilled water may provide some relief.

Beyond its medicinal properties, mint has a longstanding role in culinary arts and traditional medicine. Its refreshing flavor and aroma make it a beloved ingredient in both sweet and savory dishes worldwide. From classic mint juleps to invigorating salads and sauces, mint adds a burst of freshness that enhances any meal.

In gardening, mint is esteemed for its hardiness and ease of cultivation, appealing to both novice and experienced gardeners. Its vibrant green leaves and pleasant fragrance can transform a garden or windowsill into a lush, aromatic haven. However, due to its invasive nature, it is often recommended to plant mint in containers to prevent it from overtaking other plants.

Culturally, mint has held value for centuries. The ancient Greeks and Romans used it in rituals and regarded it as a symbol of hospitality. In contemporary times, it continues to represent warmth and welcome, frequently included in bouquets and floral arrangements.

Whether utilized for its health benefits, culinary versatility, or as a fragrant addition to the home, mint remains a cherished and multifaceted herb with a rich history and a promising future.

MINT

MUSTARD

- Sinapis alba*

Matthew 13:31; Matthew 17:20; Mark 4:31; Luke 13:19; Luke 17:6

Have you ever observed how small a mustard seed is on the spice rack? Measuring only about 1-2 millimeters in diameter, it is remarkably tiny. The Gospels present stories and parables that illustrate the profound significance of faith, comparing it to how a minuscule seed can develop into a substantial mustard bush or tree, large enough for birds to nest in its branches. Beyond its metaphorical implications, the mustard seed also boasts impressive health benefits. In Matthew 17:20, it is stated:
"Because you have so little faith, truly I tell you, if you have faith as small as a mustard seed, you can say to this mountain, 'Move from here to there,' and it will move. Nothing will be impossible for you."

For centuries, mustard seeds have been employed in traditional folk medicine. They belong to the cruciferous family of plants, which includes broccoli, cauliflower, cabbage, Brussels sprouts, and more. This remarkable seed is rich in phytonutrients and sulfur-containing compounds that offer protection against cancer and assist in detoxification. Mustard seeds are also high in selenium, omega-3 fatty acids, manganese, vitamin B1, magnesium, phosphorus, and copper.

I have a particular fondness for various types of mayonnaise and mustard, especially the spicier varieties. Have you experimented with different kinds of mustard? The heat level of mustard varies depending on the seed type used—yellow mustard seeds, often referred to as white seeds, are the mildest, while brown and black seeds deliver a stronger flavor.

The liquid that moistens the seeds in a recipe and binds the mustard significantly influences its spiciness and overall flavor. Interestingly, dried mustard seeds do not possess inherent heat; it is only when they are mixed with water that the natural enzymes awaken from their dormant state.

Regardless of color, the humble mustard seed offers anti-inflammatory properties, interacting with immune compounds to help manage inflammation. If you have ever experienced a mustard plaster for chest congestion, you are aware of how intensely warm the paste can feel upon application. These plasters are utilized to address various conditions, including rheumatism, arthritis, chest congestion, pneumonia, back pain, sore muscles, nerve pain, and abdominal discomfort. Historically, mustard has served as a stimulant, diuretic, and purgative to cleanse tissues.

When applied intentionally, mustard promotes the release of inflammation and attracts macrophages to eliminate stagnant tissues or areas of poor health. This is why mustard plasters have proven effective for coughs, joint pain, and lung congestion. Due to their potency, leaving a mustard plaster on for too long can result in skin burns. Just as in culinary applications, mustard serves as a condiment, demonstrating that this tiny, almost microscopic seed can yield significant effects in numerous ways!

MYRRH

*MYRRH**
Scientific Name: Commiphora myrrha*
References: Esther 2:12, Genesis 37:25, Exodus 30:23, Matthew 2:11, Psalm 45:8*
Myrrh is derived from the gummy resin of the myrrh tree, indigenous to Somalia. The term "myrrh" originates from the Hebrew words "murr" or "maror," which mean "bitter." Despite its pleasant aroma, myrrh should not be burned, as it produces an unpleasant odor.

Biblically, myrrh is mentioned multiple times. It was one of the gifts presented to the infant Jesus by the Magi, often interpreted as a foreshadowing of the adversities he and his family would face. References to myrrh can be found in Genesis 37:25, Exodus 30:23, Esther 2:12, Matthew 2:11, and Psalm 45:8, which states:

"All thy garments smell of myrrh, and aloes, and cassia, out of the ivory palaces, whereby they have made thee glad."*
Historically, myrrh has been utilized as a traditional remedy for treating infections. I keep four small bottles of myrrh essential oil at home and in my purse for easy inhalation or application on minor cuts and scrapes. Recently, while writing this, I sustained a deep cut on my finger from a can of V8 vegetable juice due to a tab that didn't fully detach. The bleeding persisted for about 45 minutes. After it ceased, I applied myrrh essential oil and also used the powdered form mixed with water to create a paste. Remarkably, within just two days, I was completely healed. Without myrrh, I believe the injury would have incapacitated me for a week, as it was nearly severe enough to require stitches. Note to self: perhaps V8 isn't the healthiest choice for me!

The healing properties of myrrh are so remarkable that Greek soldiers carried it into battle to treat skin infections and gangrene. It exhibits strong antibacterial, antiparasitic, and antifungal qualities. For those considering internal use, it is advisable to seek herbal extracts specifically designed for oral consumption. Research indicates that myrrh contains guggulsterones, which may help improve cholesterol levels by lowering LDL. However, caution is warranted, as guggulsterones act as blood thinners and should not be combined with aspirin, NSAIDs (Non-Steroidal Anti-Inflammatory Drugs), warfarin (Coumadin), or other blood-thinning medications.

A 2013 Chinese study identified "cycloartane-type triterpenoids" in myrrh as potentially lethal to prostate cancer cells. While centuries may pass, it is evident that frankincense and myrrh continue to be invaluable gifts to health. One final note: pregnant women should avoid myrrh, as it may stimulate the uterus.

OLIVE

OLIVE
Olea europaea
Genesis 8:11, Exodus 27:20, Deuteronomy 8:8, Kings 6:32
The olive is referenced 56 times in the Bible, with numerous passages discussing the branches of olive trees, which symbolize peace universally. An olive leaf was brought to Noah after the great flood, indicating that the waters had receded. Olive oil was utilized to fuel lamps for light and was used for the anointing of kings as a sign of honor. Additionally, olive trees provided abundant wood for temple constructions and stunning architecture.

Olives and olive oil are staples of the Mediterranean Diet, renowned for promoting heart health and longevity. This diet boasts numerous benefits, including improvements in heart health, blood pressure, cholesterol levels, cancer risk reduction, skin health, breast health, blood sugar regulation, and inflammation reduction, while also offering desirable antioxidants. Simply substituting inferior oils such as corn, soybean, or vegetable oil with extra virgin olive oil has proven beneficial for overweight and obese older adults. Research indicates that olive oil can lower blood pressure, enhance HDL levels, and support T-cell immune function.

Olive leaf offers remarkable health benefits for various challenges. You can purchase "olive leaf extract" as a natural antibiotic. This extract is often used to bolster the immune system and combat infections, particularly in the digestive and respiratory systems. The active compounds in olive leaf provide antiviral, antibacterial, antifungal, antioxidant, anticancer, and anti-inflammatory effects, along with helping to lower blood pressure.

The olive branch is a well-known symbol of peace in cultures and friendships, but we can also apply this metaphor to physiological well-being. By incorporating olive oil and olive leaf extracts, these compounds can relax the body and promote health, thereby bringing peace to an overworked and fatigued system.Incorporating olives into daily life not only enhances culinary experiences but also offers a holistic approach to wellness. The versatility of olives extends beyond the kitchen, as they play a significant role in cultural traditions, rituals, and health practices across the globe. From artisanal olive oil tastings to wellness retreats centered around the Mediterranean lifestyle, olives have become a symbol of vitality and harmony.

In the garden, olive trees are prized for their resilience and longevity, often thriving in challenging climates. They inspire us to cultivate patience and perseverance, reminding us of the enduring beauty that can emerge from life's trials. Whether used in traditional recipes or celebrated in art and literature, olives continue to enrich our lives with their timeless appeal.

As we explore the rich history and modern applications of the olive, we are invited to appreciate its profound impact on both body and spirit. Embracing the olive as a daily staple not only honors its ancient legacy but also fosters a deeper connection to the natural world and the wisdom it holds.

ONION

- *ONION**
- Allium cepa*

Numbers 11:5

I take great pleasure in incorporating fresh organic onions and dried onion powder into nearly every dish. Although chopping onions can provoke tears, their health benefits are truly remarkable.

Onions are mentioned multiple times in the Bible, particularly in Numbers 11:5, which recounts the complaints of the Israelites: "The rabble who were among them had greedy desires; and the sons of Israel wept again and said, 'Who will give us meat to eat? We remember the fish we used to eat for free in Egypt, along with the cucumbers, melons, leeks, onions, and garlic, but now our appetite is gone. There is nothing at all to look at except this manna.'" Here, manna symbolizes an unexpected, free meal.

Regardless of their variety, onions are rich in quercetin, a potent antioxidant known for its anti-cancer properties. Quercetin also functions as a natural antihistamine and can elevate dopamine levels, a hormone associated with passion. However, individuals with DBH or COMT gene SNPs should exercise caution, as elevated dopamine levels may exacerbate existing issues.

Similar to garlic, onions contain allicin, an organic sulfur compound that should not be confused with "sulfa," which can trigger allergies in some individuals. Allicin is naturally produced in both onions and garlic and serves to repel pests.

Few spices rival onions in their cancer-fighting capabilities. Research published in the *American Journal of Clinical Nutrition*, analyzing data from thousands of participants, consistently indicates that higher onion consumption correlates with increased cancer protection. Specifically, there is a 56 percent reduced risk of colon cancer and approximately a 70 percent decrease in prostate cancer risk. Additional international studies have linked greater onion intake to lower risks of endometrial, esophageal, kidney, oral, breast, pancreatic, and stomach cancers.

Beyond their health benefits, onions are a culinary powerhouse, adding depth and flavor to a myriad of dishes worldwide. From sizzling stir-fries to hearty soups and vibrant salads, their versatility and distinctive taste make them an essential ingredient in various cuisines. Whether caramelized to enhance their natural sweetness or added raw for a sharp, pungent kick, onions can elevate an ordinary meal into an extraordinary experience.

Moreover, onions have long been celebrated for their medicinal properties, having been utilized in traditional medicine for centuries to address various ailments, from earaches to colds. Their antimicrobial properties make them effective against infections, while their anti-inflammatory effects can help alleviate swelling and pain.

To maximize the benefits of onions, consider incorporating them regularly into your diet. Experimenting with different varieties—red, white, yellow, or sweet onions—each offers a unique flavor profile. Roasting, grilling, or pickling are just a few methods to enjoy this humble yet powerful vegetable in innovative ways.

In summary, whether you are relishing their rich flavor in your favorite recipe or harnessing their health-boosting properties, onions are an extraordinary addition to any kitchen and exemplify the wonders of nature's bounty.

SAFFRON

SAFFRON
Crocus sativus
Song of Solomon 4:14

Interestingly, saffron is referenced in just one verse, Song of Solomon 4:14, and it is known today as the most expensive spice. Its mention highlights its breathtaking beauty rather than any medicinal properties. A kilogram of saffron can cost over ten thousand dollars! After being picked, the flowers are placed in baskets and taken to a facility where the stigmata are extracted from the flower's center.

In addition to their visual appeal, saffron flowers are also fragrant. Once the stigmata are removed, the farms typically discard the remaining flowers, which are both beautiful and aromatic. The stigmata are dried carefully over a charcoal fire, transforming them into dark red threads that are used as a spice; prior to this heating process, they possess very little flavor. One can envision the taste of a flower's center, but it is the roasting that brings out the healing properties of saffron.

Saffron acts as an antidepressant spice, assisting with anxiety and insomnia. It is rich in biologically active compounds, such as crocin and safranal, which help maintain levels of dopamine, serotonin, and norepinephrine—similar to prescription antidepressants. Crocetin has shown promise in fighting Parkinson's disease, based on animal studies that indicated saffron could protect dopamine-generating brain cells and stabilize dopamine levels naturally.

This spice is also abundant in carotenoids, including zeaxanthin, lycopene, and β-carotene, which serve as vital antioxidants that help shield the body from free radical damage. They also support vision and bolster immune system function.

Saffron is rich in essential minerals such as copper, potassium, calcium, manganese, magnesium, iron, selenium, and zinc. Its mineral profile suggests it may assist with SOD gene SNPs, where SOD stands for superoxide dismutase. Some individuals have a gene mutation (SNP) that hinders their SOD enzyme's effectiveness, leading to an accumulation of free radicals. Since saffron provides cofactors for the SOD enzyme, it could potentially benefit those experiencing oxidative stress, particularly those with an SOD gene mutation.Additionally, saffron has been used in traditional medicine and culinary arts for centuries, not only for its medicinal properties but also for its unique flavor and vibrant color. In cooking, it is often used to enhance dishes such as risottos, paellas, and various desserts, imparting a golden hue and a distinct, earthy taste that is both subtle and complex.

Culturally, saffron holds a significant place in many regions around the world. In India, it is considered a sacred spice, used in religious ceremonies and as a symbol of purity. In Iran, which is one of the largest producers of saffron, the spice is an integral part of the national identity and is used extensively in Persian cuisine.

Saffron's allure also extends to the world of art and literature, where it has been celebrated for its beauty and rarity. Its deep connection to human history and tradition makes it much more than just a spice; it is a testament to the enduring relationship between nature and culture, a small but powerful reminder of the richness that the natural world offers us.

SAGE

- *Sage**
- *Salvia judaica**
- *Exodus 37:17**

The seven-branched candlestick, known as the Menorah, holds significant importance in Jewish history, symbolizing the seven days of creation. Its design is inspired by the sage plant, which thrived on the mountains and hills of Palestine. When viewed from a horizontal perspective, the sage plant closely resembles the shape of the Menorah described millennia ago.

*Sage extract is recognized for its cognitive health benefits, enhancing memory and improving mood. There are several varieties of sage, including an aromatic type traditionally used by Native Americans in smudging ceremonies, intended to repel negative spirits. Additionally, there are common sage (*Salvia officinalis*) and clary sage (*Salvia sclarea*). I personally enjoy purchasing fresh sage from the produce section of supermarkets and incorporating it into dishes such as chicken, soup, and meatloaf. I often add it to my slow cooker when preparing vegetable, bone, or chicken broth.*

Research conducted in Iran on patients with mild to moderate Alzheimer's disease revealed that sage produced significantly improved outcomes in cognitive function. Notably, laboratory studies have indicated that sage may help mitigate flare-ups of herpes-related viruses, including cold sores and genital herpes. Furthermore, sage exhibits anti-inflammatory and antioxidant properties, contributing to overall health and well-being. Its versatility extends beyond culinary and medicinal applications; sage has traditionally been utilized in various cultural rituals and ceremonies, valued for its purifying and protective qualities.

In the culinary realm, sage's earthy and slightly peppery flavor enhances a wide variety of dishes. It pairs exceptionally well with roasted vegetables, elevates the taste of sausages and stuffing, and can be used to infuse butters and oils, adding a fragrant touch. For those who enjoy culinary experimentation, crispy fried sage leaves can provide a delightful crunch in salads or pasta dishes.

As we continue to explore the benefits and applications of sage, it becomes evident that this humble herb offers a multitude of possibilities—both in enhancing the flavors of our meals and contributing to our health and spiritual practices. Whether utilized as a seasoning or a supplement, sage is a timeless herb that has secured its esteemed place in kitchens and healing traditions worldwide.

WORMWOOD

- WORMWOOD
- Artemisia absinthium
- Referenced in Jeremiah 9:15, Revelation 8:10, and Ruth 1:20

Wormwood, also known as Sweet Wormwood and Artemisia, is mentioned multiple times in the Holy Bible. For instance, in Ruth 1:20, it states: "And the name of the star is called Wormwood... Because of the bitter afflictions, sorrows, and distresses which it was the instrument of; just as Naomi called herself Mara, because the Almighty had dealt bitterly with her."

In Jeremiah 9:15, it says: "... and the third part of the waters became wormwood; that is, the inhabitants of the provinces and cities belonging to the Roman empire were afflicted with grievous and bitter calamities; thus, great distresses are referred to as wormwood, and waters of gall given to drink."

Wormwood is well-known for its potent properties; it acts as a strong antimicrobial, antifungal, and antiviral agent. It is commonly used in infusions, powders, tablets, tinctures, and extractions. Additionally, Wormwood is one of the components in Essiac tea, which is believed to have anti-cancer effects.

When searching for wormwood under its alternative name, "Artemesia," you may discover it frequently mentioned on various Lyme disease forums and websites. Artemisinin, a natural compound derived from wormwood, is recognized as a powerful anti-malarial agent. It can also assist with parasites and Babesia infections. Many individuals opt for high doses of artemisinin to target Babesia, a co-infection of Lyme; however, this may exacerbate tinnitus in some cases. If artemisinin causes issues while targeting Babesia, alternatives such as Sida Acuta, Cryptolepis, or Alchornea Cordifolia can be considered.

Wormwood's historical use extends beyond biblical references and modern health applications. It has a rich legacy in traditional medicine, often utilized for its digestive and pain-relieving properties. In ancient times, wormwood was employed to treat various ailments, from fever and indigestion to joint pain and inflammation.

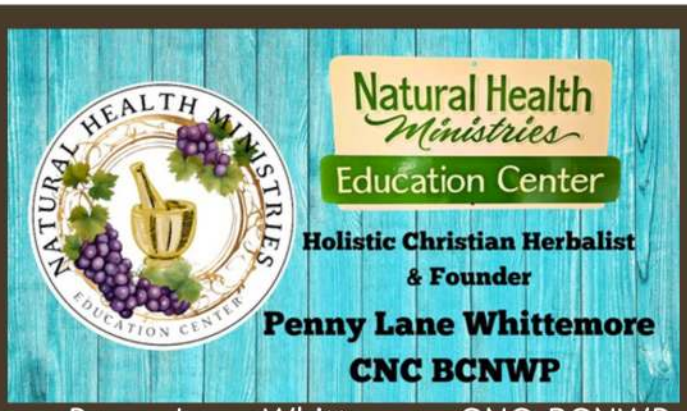
Culturally, wormwood also holds a significant place in the world of spirits, most famously as a key ingredient in absinthe, a potent and often controversial liquor. Absinthe was popularized in 19th-century France, where artists and writers celebrated its purported ability to inspire creativity and insight. However, due to its high thujone content, which can be toxic in large amounts, absinthe faced bans in several countries before making a modern comeback with regulated thujone levels.

In the garden, wormwood is valued for its silvery foliage and ability to repel pests, making it a beneficial companion plant. Its aromatic leaves can deter insects, and its presence can enhance the growth of other plants by improving soil conditions.

With its intriguing blend of myth, medicine, and lore, wormwood remains a plant of fascination, continuing to capture the imagination and interest of those who explore its multifaceted nature.







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NATURAL HEALTH MINISTRIES

Module 2



HOLISTIC CHRISTIAN HERBALIST

GUIDEBOOK

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